

Curriculum Stories

اللغة الإنجليزية

الصف العاشر

Term 1

One story for every lesson: enjoy the story and learn the whole lesson

20 stories

How to use this book

📚 One story per lesson

Each story teaches a whole lesson from your book, in the same order.

🖍️ Highlighted words

Highlighted words are the key words of the lesson.

💡 Facts

Small boxes inside the story give facts you should remember.

📖 Words

At the end of each story you find the key words with their meaning in Arabic.

🌟 What did I learn?

A short list of what the lesson teaches. Read it to check yourself.

🤔 Little questions

Try to answer alone, then look at the answer.

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Lesson 1-1 · Reading: Screenagers

The Phone-Free Week

School challenge story Unit 1: New Media

👥 Talal (15, from Sohar), his sister Reem, and their English teacher Mr Khalid

Talal was a **screenager**. Every morning he opened his eyes and reached for his phone. Every night he fell asleep with the screen still bright in his hand. His sister Reem laughed at him. "You are **glued to** that phone!" she said. "You are **addicted to** it."

"I'm not addicted," said Talal. "I'm a **digital native**. I grew up with technology. That's all."

A strange article

At school, Mr Khalid gave the class an article called **Screenagers**. "Today we read about **new media**," he said. "Who can tell me what new media is?"

Talal put up his hand. "It's media on computers, smartphones and tablets. Like **social media**, **blogs**, **video games** and **online news** sites."

"Good. And what makes it different from old media like TV?"

Nobody answered. Mr Khalid smiled. "New media is **interactive**. You don't just watch it. You click, you comment, you share. It lets people communicate digitally and connect with people all over the world."

> 💡 New media = interactive digital media, like social media, blogs, video games and online news.

The class read the article. Talal was surprised. Teens spend **nearly nine hours a day** in front of a screen! And **YouTube** is the most popular platform for teenagers. Many teens like to watch **streaming video** for hours.

"Look at this part," said Mr Khalid. "**Excessive** screen time can cause physical problems. Excessive means more than necessary. It can also shorten your **attention span**, the time you can focus on one thing."

Talal thought about his homework. He often read one page and then checked his phone. Maybe his attention span was getting shorter.

" " *

The challenge

"Here is a challenge," said Mr Khalid. "For one week, write down every hour you spend on screens. Then we will talk about the **consequences**, the results of our habits."

At home, Talal showed Reem the challenge. "Nine hours!" she said. "I think you do more than that."

On the first day, Talal counted seven hours. On the second day, six. On the third day he played a video game with his little cousin. In the game, they helped a farmer save his animals from a flood. They laughed a lot.

"Is that bad screen time?" Talal asked his father.

His father thought for a moment. "I don't think so. You were helping each other and having fun together."

The writer's conclusion

At the end of the week, the class read the last paragraph of the article again. The writer said screen time is not always negative. Some video games are good, like games where you help someone. Parents should watch the **content**, not only the hours.

"So what is more important," asked Mr Khalid, "the number of hours or the content?"

"The **content and context**," said Talal. "What we watch and why we watch it are more important than the amount of time."

"Excellent!" said Mr Khalid.

" " *

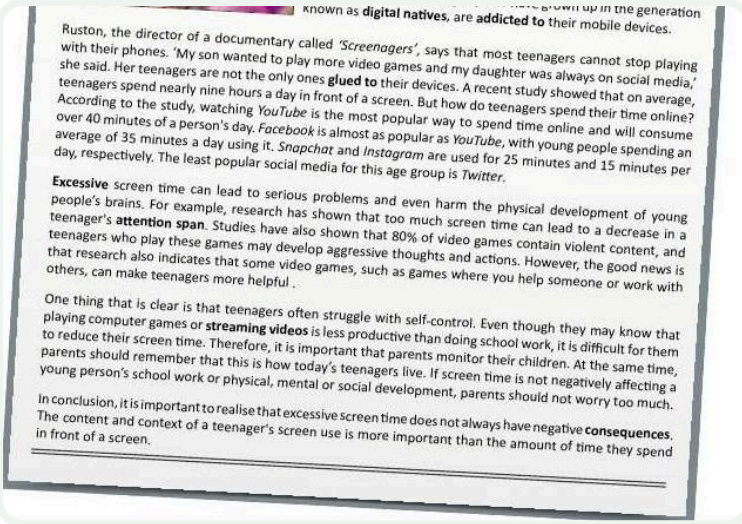
Talal's opinion

Then Mr Khalid asked a question. "Which statement is NOT true according to the article? Excessive screen time is negative regardless of content."

Talal smiled. "That one is not true. The writer says the content matters."

Finally, every student gave their opinion. Talal stood up. "**In my opinion**, teenagers spend too much time on screens, because they have less time for sport and family. **Based on my own experience, I think that** we should choose good content and use our phones less."

That evening, Talal left his phone in the living room and went to play football with Reem. "I think I am less of a screenager now," he said. Reem laughed. "Let's see tomorrow!"



known as **digital natives**, are **addicted to** their mobile devices.

Ruston, the director of a documentary called *'Screenagers'*, says that most teenagers cannot stop playing with their phones. 'My son wanted to play more video games and my daughter was always on social media,' she said. Her teenagers are not the only ones **glued to** their devices. A recent study showed that on average, teenagers spend nearly nine hours a day in front of a screen. But how do teenagers spend their time online? According to the study, watching *YouTube* is the most popular way to spend time online and will consume over 40 minutes of a person's day. *Facebook* is almost as popular as *YouTube*, with young people spending an average of 35 minutes a day using it. *Snapchat* and *Instagram* are used for 25 minutes and 15 minutes per day, respectively. The least popular social media for this age group is *Twitter*.

Excessive screen time can lead to serious problems and even harm the physical development of young people's brains. For example, research has shown that too much screen time can lead to a decrease in a teenager's **attention span**. Studies have also shown that 80% of video games contain violent content, and teenagers who play these games may develop aggressive thoughts and actions. However, the good news is that research also indicates that some video games, such as games where you help someone or work with others, can make teenagers more helpful .

One thing that is clear is that teenagers often struggle with self-control. Even though they may know that playing computer games or **streaming videos** is less productive than doing school work, it is difficult for them to reduce their screen time. Therefore, it is important that parents monitor their children. At the same time, parents should remember that this is how today's teenagers live. If screen time is not negatively affecting a young person's school work or physical, mental or social development, parents should not worry too much.

In conclusion, it is important to realise that excessive screen time does not always have negative **consequences**. The content and context of a teenager's screen use is more important than the amount of time they spend in front of a screen.

The article Screenagers

📖 Words from the story

new media
وسائل الإعلام الجديدة

interactive
تفاعلي

screenager
مراهق مدمن على الشاشات

digital native
مواطن رقمي (نشأ مع التقنية)

addicted to
مدمن على

excessive
مفرط

attention span
مدة التركيز

consequence
نتيجة / عاقبة

streaming video
بث الفيديو المباشر

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ New media is interactive and digital: social media, blogs, video games and online news
- ✔ It is used on computers, smartphones and tablets and helps us connect with people all over the world
- ✔ Teens spend nearly nine hours a day in front of a screen, and YouTube is their most popular platform
- ✔ Excessive screen time can cause physical problems and shorten the attention span
- ✔ The writer says content and context are more important than the amount of time
- ✔ We say addicted to, not addicted on
- ✔ To give an opinion: In my opinion … / I think … / Based on my own experience, I think that …

🤔 Little questions

1. Name two types of new media
   Answer: social media and blogs
2. What is the most popular platform for teens?
   Answer: YouTube
3. What does excessive mean?
   Answer: more than necessary
4. What is a digital native?
   Answer: a person who grew up with digital technology
5. According to the writer, what is more important than the hours?
   Answer: the content and context



Lesson 1-2 · Grammar and Vocabulary: Comparisons and phrasal verbs

The Great Screen Debate at Home

Family story | Unit 1: New Media

👥 The Al Rashdi family in Nizwa: Grandpa Saleh, Dad, and the twins Hamad and Hamood

Every Friday evening, the Al Rashdi family had a big argument. Not an angry one, a funny one! The question was always the same: "What is the best thing to do in the evening?"

Comparatives

Hamad loved video games. "Video games are **more exciting than** TV," he said.

Hamood loved TV. "TV screens are **larger than** computer screens," he said. "So TV is **better than** video games!"

Grandpa Saleh laughed. "Listen to you two! You are using **comparatives**. When we compare two things, short adjectives take **-er**: large, larger. Long adjectives take **more**: exciting, more exciting. And some are irregular: good, **better**. Bad, **worse**."

"Never say **more larger**," said Dad. "That's a mistake. Just say larger."

💡 Short adjectives: -er / -est. Long adjectives: more / the most.

Superlatives

Then Grandpa held up an old book. "But I think reading books is **the best** hobby of all!"

"The best?" asked Hamad.

"Yes. That's a **superlative**. We use it when we compare one thing with all the others. The TV in Hamood's room is **the largest** in the house. **The most popular** TV shows are comedy shows. And reading is **the best** hobby!"

"Not **the most best**?" joked Hamood.

"No! Just **the best**," said Grandpa.

" " *

As ... as

Dad brought out his laptop. "Look. My computer screen is **as large as** your TV screen. They are the same."

"But watching TV is **not as popular as** playing video games," said Hamad, "at least in our class."

"Remember," said Grandpa, "we say **as popular as**, not as popular than. **As ... as** means the same. **Not as ... as** means not the same."

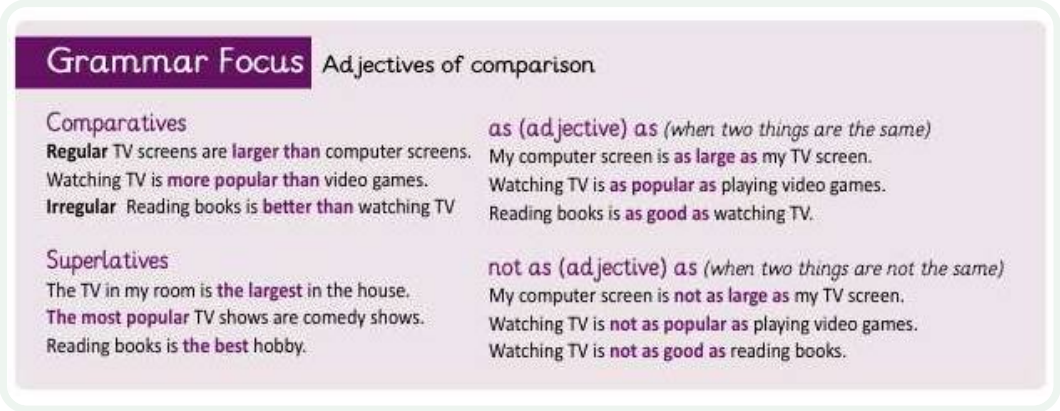
Hamood thought of a clever sentence. "Video games are more popular than TV. So... TV is **not as popular as** video games."

"Perfect!" said Dad.

A chart from school

Hamad showed a chart from his English book. It showed what boys and girls like to do. "Look, the boys are **more interested** in video games than the girls."

"Is that true, false, or not given?" asked Dad. "Read the chart carefully before you decide."



Grammar Focus: adjectives of comparison

" " *

Phrasal verbs

Later, Dad wanted to check the news on his laptop. "Wait, I need to **log in**. Where is my password?"

"You need your username and password to log in," said Hamood. "That's a **phrasal verb**, Dad! A verb with a small word after it."

"And the meaning is often different from the single verb," added Hamad. "Like **make up**. It means to invent something that is not true. Anyone can **make up** fake news online."

Dad smiled. "Every morning I **scroll through** my feeds to **keep up with** my friends' lives. Yesterday I **came across** a photo of my old school. I found it by chance!"

"**Hurry up**, Dad!" said Hamood. "**Click on** the news so we can see the football results."

Grandpa shook his head. "Phrasal verbs everywhere!"

He explained the three types:

verb + preposition: make up, click on

verb + adverb: scroll through, hurry up

verb + adverb + preposition: keep up with

" " *

The final answer

At the end of the evening, they still did not agree. Hamad said video games were the most exciting. Hamood said TV was the best. Dad said the news was more important than everything.

Grandpa closed his book. "I have the answer. The best evening is the one we spend together." And everyone agreed with that.

📖 Words from the story

comparative صيغة المقارنة	**superlative** صيغة التفضيل العليا
phrasal verb فعل مركب	**make up** يختلق
scroll through يتصفح بالتمرير	**keep up with** يواكب
come across يجد بالصدفة	**log in** يسجل الدخول
hurry up يُسرع	**click on** ينقر على

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Comparatives compare two things: larger than, more popular than, better than
- ✔ Superlatives compare one thing with all others: the largest, the most popular, the best
- ✔ Short adjectives take -er / -est and long adjectives take more / the most
- ✔ Irregular: good, better, the best and bad, worse, the worst
- ✔ as ... as means the same and not as ... as means not the same
- ✔ A phrasal verb is a verb + a small word, and its meaning is often different from the single verb
- ✔ Examples: make up, scroll through, keep up with, come across, log in, hurry up, click on

🤔 Little questions

1. What is the superlative of good?
   Answer: the best
2. What is the comparative of popular?
   Answer: more popular
3. Correct this: more larger
   Answer: larger
4. Rewrite with not as … as: Video games are more popular than TV.
   Answer: TV is not as popular as video games.
5. What does come across mean?
   Answer: find by chance



Lesson 1-3 · Listening and Speaking: The future of journalism

The Young Reporters Club

School club story Unit 1: New Media

👥 Members of the Young Reporters Club in a Muscat school: Salim, Yusuf and Ali, and their guest Dr David

The Young Reporters Club had a special guest today. Dr David was a journalist who had worked in many countries. Before he arrived, the teacher, Mr Hamdan, said, "Read the statements on the board and **underline the key words**. Then you can **predict** what you will hear."

Salim underlined: "social media", "faster", "printed newspapers", "trust".

The interview

Dr David sat down and smiled. "Today I want to talk about the future of **journalism** in the **digital age**."

Yusuf asked the first question. "Will **reporters** disappear?"

"No," said Dr David. "But their job is changing. Social media is **faster** than journalists at reporting news. When something happens, people post it in seconds."

"So why do we need journalists?" asked Ali.

"Because anyone can **post** news, but not everyone is a trusted **source**. Anyone can make up **fake news**, false news made to trick people. Journalists check facts. That's why people **trust** them."

> 💡 Fake news = false news made up to trick people. Journalists check facts so people can trust them.

The charts

Then Dr David showed two **charts**. One showed printed newspaper sales going down. The other showed online reading going up.

"Which chart matches what I said?" he asked. "More people read **electronic** newspapers, and fewer buy printed ones."

Salim pointed to the second chart. "That one! People are moving from printed to online news."

"Will printed newspapers **disappear** completely?" asked Yusuf.

"Maybe one day," said Dr David.

" " *

Agreeing and disagreeing

Mr Hamdan turned to the class. "Let's discuss. Yusuf says printed newspapers will disappear soon. Do you agree?"

Ali said, "**I agree**. Young people only read news on their phones."

Salim raised his hand. "**I see what you're saying, but** many people still like reading on paper. **For example**, my grandfather reads the newspaper every morning with his coffee."

"Good," said Mr Hamdan. "Salim gave his opinion, a **reason** and an **example**. That's how we discuss politely."

Yusuf laughed. "**I'm sorry, but I don't agree** with Salim. **The reason for this is** that newspapers are expensive to print."

"Remember," said Mr Hamdan, "we say **I agree**, never "I am agree". And we say **according to Dr David**, not according with."

He wrote useful phrases on the board:

Agreeing: I agree. / You're exactly right!

Disagreeing: I'm sorry, but I don't agree. / I see what you're saying, but ...

Giving reasons: I think this because ... / The reason for this is ...

Giving examples: For example, ... / One example of this is ...



Useful Language: giving your opinion

" " *

Word stress

At the end, Dr David said, "Journalists on radio and TV must speak clearly. Let's practise **word stress**. In every long word, one syllable is louder. That is the **stressed syllable**."

He said the words slowly and the students drew big circles over the stressed syllables:

ON-line , **CON**-se-quence , de-**VICE**

TEEN-a-ger , ex-**CESS**-ive , par-**TIC**-i-pate

"Now you try: connect, media, interactive, communicate," he said.

Ali read: "con-**NECT**, **ME**-di-a, in-ter-**AC**-tive, com-**MU**-ni-cate."

"Perfect! You can be a radio reporter," said Dr David.

After the visit, the club wrote their first online news story. Before they posted it, Salim checked every fact twice. "We are a trusted source now," he said proudly.

📖 Words from the story

journalism الصحافة	**reporter** مراسل
fake news أخبار كاذبة	**source** مصدر
trust ثقة	**disappear** يختفي
digital age العصر الرقمي	**stressed syllable** المقطع المنبور

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Before listening, read the statements and underline key words to predict
- ✔ Social media is faster than journalists at reporting news, but not everyone is a trusted source
- ✔ Fake news is false news made up to trick people
- ✔ More people read electronic newspapers and fewer buy printed ones
- ✔ Agree: I agree. Disagree politely: I see what you're saying, but ...
- ✔ Always give a reason and an example with your opinion
- ✔ Word stress: ON-line, CON-se-quence, de-VICE, TEEN-a-ger, ex-CESS-ive

🤔 Little questions

1. What is fake news?
   Answer: false news made up to trick people
2. Where is the stress in device?
   Answer: de-VICE

3. Where is the stress in consequence?
   Answer: CON-se-quence (first syllable)
4. Give one phrase for disagreeing
   Answer: I'm sorry, but I don't agree
5. Correct this: I am agree.
   Answer: I agree.

Lesson 1-4 · Writing: A summary of two pie charts

Two Circles of Colour

School story Unit 1: New Media

👥 Muna (16, from Ibra) who loves maths, her friend Shatha, and their English teacher Ms Fatma

Muna loved numbers, but she did not love writing. So when Ms Fatma said, "Today you will write a **summary** of two charts," Muna was happy and worried at the same time.

Types of charts

Ms Fatma drew four pictures on the board.

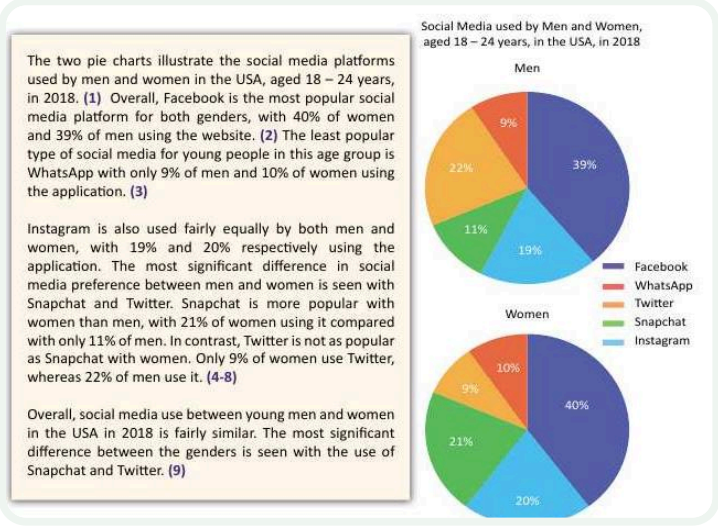
"This is a **column chart**, with vertical columns. This is a **bar chart**, with horizontal bars. This is a **line graph**, a line that shows change over time. And this is a **pie chart**, a circle divided into parts. Each part is a percentage."

"Like a pizza!" said Shatha. Everyone laughed.

💡 Pie chart = a circle divided into parts that show percentages of a whole.

The two pie charts

Ms Fatma showed two pie charts. They showed the social media platforms used by men and women aged 18 to 24 in the USA in 2018.



A model summary of two pie charts

"What do they **illustrate**?" asked Ms Fatma. "Illustrate means show."

Muna studied the charts. She loved this part. "Facebook is the biggest part in both circles. So it is the most popular for men and for women."

"Good. That is the **highest proportion**. A proportion is a part of the whole."

"And WhatsApp is the smallest," said Shatha. "It is the **least** popular."

" " *

The structure

Ms Fatma wrote the plan:

> Introduction → Highest → Lowest → Comparisons → Conclusion

"First, the **introduction**: say what the charts show. Then the **highest** and **lowest** data. Then **comparisons**. Finally, the **conclusion**, starting with **Overall**. Overall means in general."

Muna started writing:

> The two pie charts illustrate the social media platforms used by men and women in the USA in 2018.

"Excellent first sentence," said Ms Fatma.

Comparing with whereas

Then Muna looked at Twitter. Only 9% of women used it, but 22% of men used it. She wanted to show the difference.

"Use **whereas**," said Ms Fatma. "It means **while**."

Muna wrote:

> Only 9% of women use Twitter, whereas 22% of men use it.

"And for a big difference you can say **the most significant difference is** … Significant means important or noticeable. You can also use **in contrast**, which means on the other hand."

Shatha wrote:

> Instagram is used fairly equally by both men and women. In contrast, the most significant difference is seen with Snapchat and Twitter.

" " *

No opinions!

Shatha added a sentence at the end: "I think Facebook is the best app."

Ms Fatma shook her head kindly. "A summary does **not** have your opinion. Just the facts from the chart. Write: 'Facebook is the most popular platform.'"

"And use the **present tense**," she added. "The chart **illustrates**, not "the chart illustrate"."

Muna checked her summary. She used numbers from the chart to support every point. She finished with:

> Overall, social media use between young men and women in the USA is fairly similar.

Ms Fatma read it and smiled. "Muna, you said you don't like writing. But this is one of the best summaries in the class."

Muna laughed. "That's because it's full of numbers!"

📖 Words from the story

pie chart مخطط دائري	**column chart** مخطط أعمدة
line graph رسم بياني خطي	**bar chart** مخطط شريطي
illustrate يوضح	**overall** بشكل عام
in contrast على النقيض	**whereas** بينما
significant ملحوظ / مهم	**proportion** نسبة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Column chart = vertical columns, bar chart = horizontal bars, line graph = change over time, pie chart = parts of a whole
- ✔ A summary has: introduction, highest, lowest, comparisons and conclusion
- ✔ Start with: The two pie charts illustrate …
- ✔ Use comparison words: whereas, in contrast, the most significant difference is …
- ✔ Overall means in general and starts the conclusion
- ✔ Write in the present simple and use numbers from the chart
- ✔ Do not add your personal opinion in a summary

🤔 Little questions

1. What does a pie chart show?
   Answer: parts of a whole as percentages
2. What is a synonym of while?
   Answer: whereas
3. Which tense do we use in summaries?
   Answer: present simple
4. Should you add your opinion in a summary?
   Answer: No
5. Correct this: The chart illustrate
   Answer: The chart illustrates

Lesson 1-5 · Project: Design a blog

Green Oman Online

Team project story · Unit 1: New Media

👥 A group of four friends in Sur: Ahmed, Khalid, Nasser and Saif

Mr Saeed showed the class a website on the big screen. At the top was a robot and the title **Robot Diaries**.

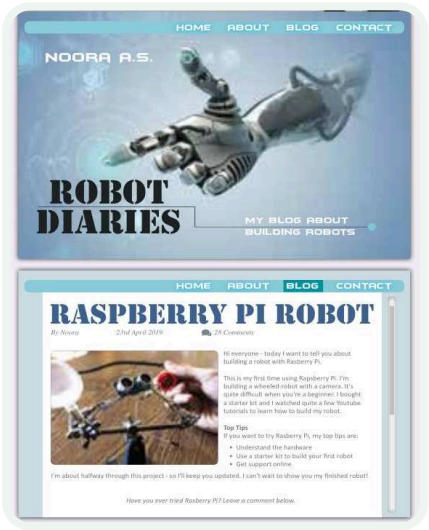
"This is **Noora's blog**," he said. "A **blog** is a website where someone writes regularly about something they love. Noora loves building robots."

Homepage and blog post

"Every blog has two main parts," said Mr Saeed. "The **homepage** is the first page. Look: it has a title, a menu with Home, About, Blog and Contact, and a big picture."

Then he clicked on Blog. A new page opened: **Raspberry Pi Robot**.

"This is a **blog post**, one article on the blog. It has a date, a photo, top tips and comments from readers."



Noora's blog: homepage and blog post

💡 A blog has a homepage (title, menu, picture) and blog posts (date, photo, tips, comments).

Tips for a good blog

Mr Saeed gave each group a list of tips. "Sort them into three groups: **content**, **design** and **technical**."

Ahmed's group read and sorted:

Content: blog about things you love, blog regularly, include lots of photos

Design: choose a design **theme**, attractive colours, a font that is easy to read

Technical: get **hosted**, add social media and like buttons

"Is "Choose attractive colours" content or design?" asked Khalid.

"Design," said Nasser.

"And there is one more very important tip," said Mr Saeed. "**Safety**. Do not post **personal details** on your blog, like your address or phone number. That's how you stay safe online."

" " *

Planning in a team

"Now design your own blog," said Mr Saeed. "Make **suggestions** and respond to your friends."

Saif started. "**Let's** make a blog about football."

"I'm not sure," said Ahmed. "**How about** making a blog about nature in Oman? Turtles, mountains, beaches..."

"**That's a great idea!**" said Khalid. "**Why don't we** call it "Green Oman"?"

"Perfect," said Nasser.

Mr Saeed listened and smiled. "Good! But remember: we say **Let's make**, not let's to make. And **How about making**, not how about make."

The plan

The group answered the planning questions:

What is your blog about? Nature in Oman.

What will you call it? Green Oman.

What design, **layout** and **features** will it have? A green and blue theme, a big photo of Ras Al Jinz turtles, a map, and a photo gallery.

Why will it be **appealing** to readers? It has beautiful photos and short, interesting posts.

How will it stand out from other blogs? Every week we post one tip to protect nature.

" " *

The first post

Nasser drew the homepage. Ahmed wrote the first blog post: "Five Things I Learned About Green Turtles". Khalid chose a font that was easy to read. Saif added like buttons and a contact page with the school email only, no personal details.

On presentation day, the class voted. Green Oman won the prize for the most appealing design.

"Next week we post about Jebel Akhdar," said Saif. "Bloggers must blog regularly!"

📖 Words from the story

blog — مدونة

homepage — الصفحة الرئيسية

blog post — تدوينة

feature — ميزة

layout — تصميم الصفحة / التخطيط

host — يستضيف (موقعًا)

theme — قالب / سمة

personal details — معلومات شخصية

appealing — جذاب

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Noora's blog Robot Diaries has a homepage (title, menu, big picture) and blog posts (date, photo, tips, comments)
- ✔ Content tips: blog about things you love, blog regularly, include photos
- ✔ Design tips: choose a theme, attractive colours and an easy font
- ✔ Technical tips: get hosted and add social media and like buttons
- ✔ Safety: do not post personal details
- ✔ Suggestions: Let's … / How about …ing? / Why don't we …?
- ✔ Responses: That's a great idea! / I'm not sure, how about …?

🤔 Little questions

1. What are the two parts of Noora's blog?
   Answer: homepage and blog post

2. Is choose attractive colours content, design or technical?

   Answer: design

3. Give one safety tip

   Answer: do not post personal details

4. Correct this: Let's to make a blog.

   Answer: Let's make a blog.

5. Correct this: How about make a blog?

   Answer: How about making a blog?

Lesson 2-1 · Reading: Climate change

The Sea That Came Closer

Family story Unit 2: Climate Change

👥 Hamed (15) and his grandfather, an old fisherman in Al Ashkharah

Every summer, Hamed visited his grandfather in Al Ashkharah. Grandpa was an old fisherman. One evening they walked on the beach. Grandpa stopped and pointed at a broken wall in the sand.

"When I was your age, this wall was far from the water," he said. "Now the sea is almost touching it."

"Why, Grandpa?"

"Ask your science books. I only know that the summers are hotter and the sea is higher."

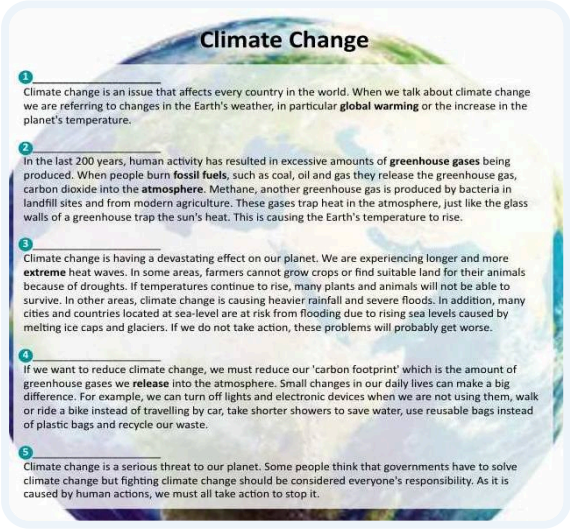
What is climate change?

At home, Hamed opened his English book. The reading text was called **Climate Change**.

"**Climate** is the weather in one place over a long period," he read aloud. "It is not the weather today."

"So climate is like the weather's habit," said Grandpa.

"Yes! And **climate change** is a change or increase in average global temperatures. **Global warming** is the increase in temperatures on Earth. It affects every country in the world."



Climate Change

1 _____
Climate change is an issue that affects every country in the world. When we talk about climate change we are referring to changes in the Earth's weather, in particular **global warming** or the increase in the planet's temperature.

2 _____
In the last 200 years, human activity has resulted in excessive amounts of **greenhouse gases** being produced. When people burn **fossil fuels**, such as coal, oil and gas they release the greenhouse gas, carbon dioxide into the **atmosphere**. Methane, another greenhouse gas is produced by bacteria in landfill sites and from modern agriculture. These gases trap heat in the atmosphere, just like the glass walls of a greenhouse trap the sun's heat. This is causing the Earth's temperature to rise.

3 _____
Climate change is having a devastating effect on our planet. We are experiencing longer and more **extreme** heat waves. In some areas, farmers cannot grow crops or find suitable land for their animals because of droughts. If temperatures continue to rise, many plants and animals will not be able to survive. In other areas, climate change is causing heavier rainfall and severe floods. In addition, many cities and countries located at sea-level are at risk from flooding due to rising sea levels caused by melting ice caps and glaciers. If we do not take action, these problems will probably get worse.

4 _____
If we want to reduce climate change, we must reduce our 'carbon footprint' which is the amount of greenhouse gases we **release** into the atmosphere. Small changes in our daily lives can make a big difference. For example, we can turn off lights and electronic devices when we are not using them, walk or ride a bike instead of travelling by car, take shorter showers to save water, use reusable bags instead of plastic bags and recycle our waste.

5 _____
Climate change is a serious threat to our planet. Some people think that governments have to solve climate change but fighting climate change should be considered everyone's responsibility. As it is caused by human actions, we must all take action to stop it.

The reading text: Climate Change

The causes

Hamed read the next paragraph. "When people burn **fossil fuels**, like coal, oil and gas, they **release** carbon dioxide into the **atmosphere**. Also, bacteria in landfill and farming

produce **methane**."

"What is the atmosphere?" asked Grandpa.

"The layer of air around the Earth. Carbon dioxide and methane are **greenhouse gases**. They **trap** the sun's heat."

"Trap?" asked Grandpa.

Hamed looked at the sentence before and after. "I think trap means to keep something inside so it cannot escape. Like a fish in your net, Grandpa!"

Grandpa laughed. "Now I understand."

"The text says the gases are like the glass walls of a **greenhouse**. The heat comes in but cannot go out."

> 💡 Greenhouse gases trap the sun's heat like the glass walls of a greenhouse.

" " *

The effects

"And what happens next?" asked Grandpa.

Hamed read:

> Longer and more extreme **heat waves**.
>
> Farmers lose crops because of **droughts**, long periods without rain.
>
> Plants and animals may not survive.
>
> **Ice caps** and glaciers melt, so sea levels rise, and coastal cities are at risk of **flooding**.

Grandpa looked at the window towards the sea. "So that is why the sea came closer to our wall."

"Yes, Grandpa. And fossil fuels are not renewable. They will run out one day too."

What can we do?

"So what can a fisherman and his grandson do?" asked Grandpa.

Hamed found the last paragraph. "We must reduce our **carbon footprint**, the amount of greenhouse gases we release. We can turn off lights and devices, walk or ride a bike instead of using the car, use reusable bags and recycle our waste."

"Then it is everyone's responsibility," said Grandpa.

"Exactly! The text says fighting climate change is everyone's responsibility."

" " *

The next morning, Hamed turned off the air conditioner when he left his room. Grandpa walked to the mosque instead of driving. On the beach, they picked up plastic bags.

"Matching paragraphs with subheadings is easy now," Hamed told his teacher after the holiday. "What is climate change? Causes. Effects. How can we stop climate change? I learned them from my grandfather's wall."

📖 Words from the story

climate المناخ	**global warming** الاحتباس الحراري
greenhouse gases الغازات الدفيئة	**fossil fuels** الوقود الأحفوري
atmosphere الغلاف الجوي	**drought** جفاف
flood فيضان	**ice caps** القمم الجليدية
carbon footprint البصمة الكربونية	**release** يُطلق

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Climate is the weather in one place over a long period, not the weather today
- ✔ Global warming is the increase in temperatures on Earth
- ✔ Burning fossil fuels (coal, oil, gas) releases carbon dioxide, and landfill and farming produce methane
- ✔ Greenhouse gases trap the sun's heat like the glass walls of a greenhouse
- ✔ Effects: heat waves, droughts, flooding of coastal cities as ice caps melt
- ✔ We can reduce our carbon footprint: turn off lights, walk or ride a bike, use reusable bags, recycle
- ✔ To guess a new word, read the sentence before and after it

🤔 Little questions

1. Name a greenhouse gas
   Answer: carbon dioxide or methane

2. Name a fossil fuel

   Answer: coal, oil or gas

3. What is a carbon footprint?

   Answer: the amount of greenhouse gases we release

4. What does trap mean?

   Answer: to keep something inside so it cannot escape

5. Are fossil fuels renewable?

   Answer: No, they will run out



Lesson 2-2 · Grammar and Vocabulary: Cause and effect, compound nouns

The Polar Bear Poster

School story Unit 2: Climate Change

👥 Classmates Faisal and Majid in a school in Ibri, and their teacher Mr Sultan

Faisal and Majid had to make a poster about animals in danger because of climate change. Faisal chose the polar bear. Majid chose the koala.

"We need to use **cause and effect** language," said Mr Sultan. "The **cause** is what makes something happen. The **effect** is the result."

Cause first

Faisal wrote: "The ice melts. Polar bears die."

"Join them," said Mr Sultan. "When the cause comes first, use **so**, **therefore** or **consequently** before the effect."

Faisal tried:

> As the ice **melts**, it is harder for polar bears to survive, **so** many polar bears are dying.
>
> Temperatures are rising, **therefore** Arctic ice is melting.

"Good. You can also say: **One consequence of** melting ice is that many polar bears are dying. Or **One result of** ... or **One effect of** ..."

> 💡 so / therefore / consequently → before the effect.

Effect first

Majid wrote about koalas. "Koalas live in eucalyptus trees. That is their **habitat**, their home. But carbon dioxide affects eucalyptus leaves."

"Now put the effect first," said Mr Sultan. "Use **due to**, **because of** or **as a result of** before the cause."

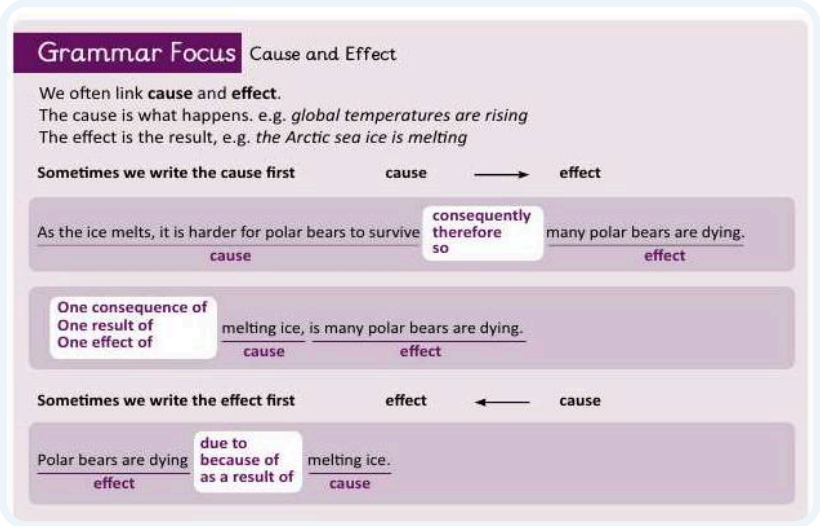
Majid wrote:

> The koala's habitat is at risk **due to** carbon dioxide affecting eucalyptus leaves.
>
> Polar bears are dying **as a result of** melting ice.

Then he wrote: "Polar bears are dying due to it is hot."

"Careful!" said Mr Sultan. "After **because of** and **due to** we use a **noun**, not a full sentence. Say **due to the heat**."

> 💡 because of / due to / as a result of → before the cause (+ noun).



Grammar Focus: cause and effect

" " *

Compound nouns

While they coloured the poster, Faisal said, "Pass me the **textbook**, please."

"That's a **compound noun**!" said Majid. "A noun made of two or more words. Text + book."

Mr Sultan smiled. "There are three types. Some are **joined**: armchair, classmate, sunglasses, thunderstorm, football. Some have a **hyphen**: dry-cleaning, one-year-old, passer-by. And some are **separate words**: air conditioner, alarm clock, ice cream, **fossil fuel**."

"So I can't write "fossilfuel"?" asked Faisal.

"No. It's two separate words. If you're not sure, a dictionary shows the correct way."

The guessing game

To relax, Mr Sultan played a game. "I will draw each part, and you guess the compound noun."

He drew a sun and a pair of glasses.

"**Sunglasses**!" shouted the class.

He drew a foot and a ball.

"**Football**! A joined compound noun!"

Then he drew a person walking past a shop.

"Passer-by! With a hyphen!" said Majid.

" " *

The finished poster

At the end, the poster was ready. In big letters it said:

Temperatures are rising, **consequently** the ice is melting.

Polar bears are losing their habitat **because of** the melting ice.

One effect of climate change is that koalas have less food.

Turn off the **air conditioner** when you leave the room!

Mr Sultan put it on the classroom wall. "Excellent cause and effect," he said. "And four compound nouns. Can you find them?"

📖 Words from the story

cause سبب	**effect** نتيجة / أثر
consequently نتيجةً لذلك	**therefore** لذلك
due to بسبب	**as a result of** نتيجةً لـ
compound noun اسم مركب	**habitat** موطن
melt يذوب	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ A cause makes something happen and an effect is the result
- ✔ Cause first: so, therefore, consequently before the effect
- ✔ One consequence of / One result of / One effect of … is …
- ✔ Effect first: due to, because of, as a result of before the cause
- ✔ After because of and due to we use a noun, not a full sentence: due to the heat
- ✔ Compound nouns: joined (classmate), with a hyphen (passer-by) or separate words (fossil fuel)
- ✔ A dictionary shows the correct way to write a compound noun

🤔 Little questions

1. Which connector comes before an effect?
   Answer: therefore
2. Which connector comes before a cause?
   Answer: because of
3. Correct this: due to it is hot
   Answer: due to the heat
4. What type of compound noun is passer-by?
   Answer: with a hyphen
5. Foot + ball makes which compound noun?
   Answer: football



Lesson 2-3 · Listening and Speaking: A class debate

The Big Debate

School debate story | Unit 2: Climate Change

👥 Grade 10 boys in a school in Barka: Omar, Badr and Zakariya, and their teacher Mr Juma

The hall was full. Today Grade 10 had a **debate**. The topic was written on the board:

> Governments should do more to stop global warming.

"In a debate," said Mr Juma, "one team speaks **for** the topic and one team speaks **against** it. Each team gives **arguments**, reasons to support their opinion."

New words first

Before the debate, Mr Juma checked some words.

"A **policy** is a set of rules. An **emission** is when gas, heat or light is released, like car emissions. To **regulate** means to control with rules. A **consumer** is a person who buys goods. **Eco-friendly** means not harmful to the environment."

"Eco-friendly means cheap?" joked Badr.

"No!" laughed Mr Juma. "Eco-friendly products are often expensive. It means good for the environment."

Team For

Omar stood up for the first team. "We think governments must do more. **We need new policies and laws** to control global warming. Governments can **regulate** factory emissions. Also, people are unlikely to change their habits on their own."

Then Badr added, "Governments have a **responsibility** to educate people about climate change."

> 💡 For: we need policies and laws, people are unlikely to change their habits, governments must educate people.

" " *

Team Against

Zakariya stood up for the second team. "**I see your point, but** we don't completely agree. **Individual people** have to take more responsibility. Every **consumer** can choose better products."

Omar raised his hand. "**I'm afraid I disagree.** Many people **cannot afford** eco-friendly products."

"**That's a good point**," said Zakariya. "But small changes cost nothing. Turning off a light is free!"

"**I completely agree with you**," said Badr, smiling. "That's true."

Mr Juma wrote the phrases on the board:

> I completely agree with you. / That's a good point.
>
> I'm afraid I disagree. / I see your point, but ...

"And never say "I am disagree"," he added. "Say **I disagree**."

Word stress for strong points

"In a debate, use **word stress** to emphasise the important word," said Mr Juma. "Listen: Saving the planet is **MORE** important than money."

Zakariya tried: "We **ALL** have to help, not only the government!"

The audience clapped.

"Remember the plan," said Mr Juma. "State your opinion, give a reason, then give an example."

" " *

Reducing our carbon footprint

After the debate, Mr Juma showed a poster. "Whatever team you were on, we can all reduce our carbon footprint. Choose the best ways for your family."



Ways to reduce your carbon footprint

The boys read:

> Turn off electronic devices you are not using.
>
> Use less air conditioning and use energy-saving bulbs.
>
> Fill the kettle with only as much water as you need.
>
> Take showers instead of baths.
>
> Walk, ride a bike or take public transport.
>
> Buy local fruit and vegetables and plant trees.

"Why buy local fruit?" asked Omar.

"Because transporting food around the world burns fossil fuels," said Zakariya.

Badr chose energy-saving bulbs. Omar chose walking to the mosque. Zakariya promised to plant a lemon tree.

"So who won the debate?" asked Badr.

Mr Juma smiled. "The planet won, because you all want to help it."

📖 Words from the story

policy سياسة / مجموعة قواعد	**emission** انبعاث
responsibility مسؤولية	**regulate** ينظّم / يضبط
consumer مستهلك	**eco-friendly** صديق للبيئة
debate مناظرة	**argument** حجة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The debate topic: Governments should do more to stop global warming
- ✔ For: we need new policies and laws, and people are unlikely to change their habits
- ✔ Against: individuals must take more responsibility, and many people cannot afford eco-friendly products
- ✔ Agree: I completely agree with you / That's a good point
- ✔ Disagree: I'm afraid I disagree / I see your point, but ...
- ✔ Stress the key word to make your point stronger
- ✔ Reduce your carbon footprint: turn off devices, energy-saving bulbs, showers not baths, walk, buy local food, plant trees

🤔 Little questions

1. What does emission mean?
   Answer: releasing gas, heat or light
2. What is a consumer?
   Answer: a person who buys goods
3. Is this for or against: Governments have a responsibility to educate people?
   Answer: for
4. Give one way to save water
   Answer: take showers instead of baths
5. Why buy local fruit?
   Answer: transporting food burns fossil fuels



Lesson 2-4 · Writing: An opinion essay

The Turtle and the Plastic Bag

Story with an essay Unit 2: Climate Change

👥 Laila (15, from Ras Al Hadd), her mother, and her English teacher Ms Maryam

Laila lived near the turtle beach at Ras Al Hadd. One morning she walked on the beach with her mother and saw something terrible. A small turtle was **tangled** in a plastic bag. Her mother gently cut the plastic, and the turtle swam away.

Laila was angry and sad. "Why do people throw plastic into the sea?"

That week, Ms Maryam gave the class a writing task: **an opinion essay** about plastic pollution in Oman. Laila knew exactly what to write.

Facts first

Ms Maryam shared some facts about **plastic pollution**:

> Every year we put **8 million tonnes** of plastic into the oceans.
>
> **Hundreds of thousands** of marine animals die each year from eating or getting trapped in plastic.
>
> By **2050** there may be more plastic in the oceans than fish.

"**Marine life** means animals and plants in the sea," said Ms Maryam. "Many die as a result of getting tangled in plastic."

"That's cause and effect!" said Laila. "The cause is getting tangled in plastic. The effect is that marine animals die."

The model essay

Ms Maryam showed a model essay: "We should use less plastic to protect our oceans."



We should use less plastic to protect our oceans. Do you agree or disagree?

Our oceans are under threat because of plastic pollution. Plastic waste, such as packaging, cups and straws is lightweight and so it often gets blown or washed into the ocean. Some people do not want to stop using plastic products because they are convenient. However, I believe that we must use less plastic to protect the oceans.

One reason why we should use less plastic is that plastic pollution is dangerous to both marine life and humans. Many marine animals die as a result of getting tangled in plastic or eating plastic. Furthermore, scientists have discovered that if you eat fish, you may be eating pieces of plastic that the fish has eaten. Therefore, it is essential to take action to address this problem.

Another reason we should use less plastic is because it is easy to do and making small changes in our daily lives will help improve this problem. For example, a million plastic bottles are sold every minute worldwide. They are used once and then thrown away. However, we could easily use reusable bottles instead and this would help reduce the amount of plastic that end up in the ocean.

To sum up, plastic waste is a serious threat to our oceans, but we can all reduce the amount of plastic we use and protect the oceans.

Model opinion essay: use less plastic

"An opinion essay has **four paragraphs**," she said.

> Paragraph 1: explain the topic and state your opinion. (However, I believe that …)
>
> Paragraph 2: the first reason with examples. (One reason why …)
>
> Paragraph 3: the second reason with examples. (Another reason …)
>
> Paragraph 4: summarise and remind the reader of your opinion. (To sum up, …)

💡 Opinion essay = 4 paragraphs: opinion, reason 1, reason 2, conclusion.

" " *

Laila writes

Laila started:

> Our oceans are under threat because of plastic pollution. Some people say that plastic is cheap and useful. However, I believe that we should use much less plastic in Oman.

For paragraph 2, she wrote her **topic sentence**:

> One reason why we should use less plastic is that it is dangerous to marine life.

Then she gave an Omani example: the little turtle at Ras Al Hadd.

"Use real examples from Oman for each reason," said Ms Maryam. "And use linking words."

For paragraph 3 she wrote:

> Another reason is that plastic is dangerous to humans, too. Small pieces of plastic go into fish, and people eat the fish. **Furthermore**, it is easy to make small changes.

"Furthermore means in addition," said Ms Maryam. "Good."

Laila added: *We can use **reusable** bottles instead of **single-use** plastic ones. A million plastic bottles are sold every minute worldwide!*

She also found a **phrasal verb** (throw away) and a **compound noun** (water bottle) in her paragraph.

The conclusion

Laila wrote "To sum up" at the start of her first paragraph by mistake. Ms Maryam smiled. "**To sum up** means in conclusion. Use it only in the **last** paragraph."

Laila moved it:

> To sum up, plastic waste is a serious threat to our oceans, but we can all reduce it. I believe every family in Oman can choose reusable bags and bottles.

"One more thing," said Ms Maryam. "Don't write "In my opinion I think". Choose one: **In my opinion, ...** or **I think ...**"

" " *

Laila's essay was read on the school radio. The next week, the whole school started a campaign: "No single-use plastic on our beach!" Laila thought about the little turtle. "Maybe it is swimming safely now," she whispered.

📖 Words from the story

opinion essay مقال رأي	**plastic pollution** التلوث البلاستيكي
marine life الحياة البحرية	**single-use** للاستخدام مرة واحدة
get tangled يعلق / يتشابك	**reusable** قابل لإعادة الاستخدام
to sum up خلاصة القول	**furthermore** علاوة على ذلك

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Facts: 8 million tonnes of plastic go into the oceans every year, and by 2050 there may be more plastic than fish
- ✔ Hundreds of thousands of marine animals die from eating or getting tangled in plastic
- ✔ An opinion essay has four paragraphs: opinion, first reason, second reason, conclusion
- ✔ Useful starters: However, I believe that … / One reason why … / Another reason … / Furthermore … / To sum up …
- ✔ Give a real example from Oman for each reason
- ✔ Use To sum up only in the conclusion
- ✔ Write In my opinion, … or I think …, not both together

🤔 Little questions

1. How many paragraphs are in an opinion essay?
   Answer: four
2. Where is the opinion first stated?
   Answer: paragraph 1
3. What does paragraph 4 do?
   Answer: summarises and reminds the reader of the opinion
4. What does furthermore mean?
   Answer: in addition
5. Find the cause in: Many marine animals die as a result of getting tangled in plastic.
   Answer: getting tangled in plastic



Lesson 2-5 · Project: A reusable shopping bag

The Bag That Talks

Team project story · Unit 2: Climate Change

👥 Four girls in a school in Rustaq: Asma, Huda, Nouf and Sumaya, and their teacher Ms Salma

"Can a shopping bag talk?" asked Ms Salma.

The girls laughed. "No, Miss!"

"Look at these," she said. She showed **reusable** shopping bags. Each one had a **message**:

> Let's go green and keep the planet clean
>
> Reduce your carbon footprint
>
> Keep your future bright, turn off the light!
>
> There will be more plastic than fish in the oceans by 2050

"Every bag talks to everyone who sees it," said Ms Salma. "Today you will **design** your own talking bag."

Tips from a designer

Ms Salma played a recording of a designer explaining his bag. The girls listened for details and wrote:

> A **slogan** that is **memorable** and simple.
>
> An **image** that is easy to understand and reflects the message.
>
> A **colour** that connects to your message.
>
> A **material** that is strong and environmentally friendly.

"Memorable means easy to remember," said Asma. "So the slogan should be short."

"Exactly," said Ms Salma. "A slogan must **not** be long. Short, simple and direct."

" " *

Brainstorming

The group sat together. "What will our message be?" asked Huda.

"Plastic pollution in the ocean," said Nouf. "My uncle is a fisherman in Sur. He finds plastic in his nets every day."

"For the image," said Sumaya, "let's draw **plastic bottles instead of fish**, inside a fishing net."

"And the main colour?"

"**Blue**," said Asma, "because blue represents the ocean. It connects to our message."

"What **material**?" asked Huda.

"**Recycled** plastic bottles!" said Nouf. "It is eco-friendly, and fewer bottles end up in the ocean."

> 💡 A good bag: clear message, simple image, connected colour, eco-friendly material, memorable slogan.

The slogan

They tried many slogans. Sumaya wrote a long sentence with twenty words. Everyone laughed. "Too long!"

Then Huda said, "Fish, not plastic!"

"That's it! Short and memorable," said Asma.



Example: our reusable shopping bag

" " *

Explaining and evaluating

"Now explain your design," said Ms Salma. "You can write a paragraph, bullet points or a spider diagram. And remember, your design can be a drawing, a **collage** or a 3D model."

The group wrote a short paragraph:

The message on our reusable bag is about plastic pollution in the ocean. The image shows plastic bottles instead of fish. Our main colour is blue because it represents the ocean. The bag is made of recycled plastic bottles because it is eco-friendly.

Then every group **evaluated** the other bags. They gave a score from 1 to 5 for the design, image, slogan, colour, material and explanation.

The "Fish, not plastic!" bag got five out of five for the slogan.

Ms Salma made the bags real. A local shop agreed to print them. Now, when Nouf's uncle buys fish bait, he carries it in a blue bag that talks.

📖 Words from the story

reusable قابل لإعادة الاستخدام	**slogan** شعار
message رسالة	**design** تصميم
material مادة / خامة	**memorable** لا يُنسى
evaluate يقيّم	**recycled** معاد تدويره

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Reusable bags can carry messages about climate change
- ✔ A good slogan is memorable, simple and direct, not long
- ✔ The image should be easy to understand and reflect the message
- ✔ The colour should connect to the message, like blue for the ocean
- ✔ Choose a strong, eco-friendly material such as recycled plastic bottles
- ✔ Explain your design in a paragraph, bullet points or a spider diagram
- ✔ Evaluate each bag with a score from 1 to 5 for design, image, slogan, colour, material and explanation

🤔 Little questions

1. What makes a good slogan?
   Answer: memorable, simple and direct

2. Why choose blue for a bag about the ocean?
   Answer: because blue represents the ocean
3. Why is recycled material good?
   Answer: it is eco-friendly
4. What does reusable mean?
   Answer: can be used many times
5. How is a bag evaluated?
   Answer: a score from 1 to 5 for each part

Lesson 3-1 · Reading: Emails about renewable energy

Luke and the Heavy Trolley

Email story · Unit 3: Renewable Energy

👥 Luke, a teenager with a big idea, and his uncle Bill, an engineer

Luke hated shopping day. Every Saturday he went to the mall with his mother. And every Saturday, he pushed the shopping trolley. It was full, **heavy** and hard to push.

"One day," Luke said, "I will make a trolley that moves by itself."

His mother laughed. "Good idea. Make it for your school project!"

Luke's email

That evening, Luke wrote an email to his uncle Bill, an engineer.

Subject: Help with my school project

Hi Uncle Bill,

I need your help. For my school project, I want to make an **invention**: an automatic trolley powered by **renewable energy**. Shopping trolleys are heavy and hard to push. Maybe a small panel can **convert** the light in the mall into electricity. What do you think?

Thanks, Luke

"What is the **purpose** of Luke's email?" his teacher asked later. "Read the subject line. It tells you. He wants to **ask for help** with a school project."

Renewable or non-renewable?

Two days later, Uncle Bill replied.

Hi Luke,

What a great idea! First, you must understand the difference. **Renewable** energy comes from sources that never **run out**: wind, the sun, biomass, water and geothermal heat. **Non-renewable** energy will run out one day: oil, coal, natural gas and nuclear power.

Luke read it twice. "So natural gas is non-renewable because it will run out."

"Renewable means it comes back again," his mother said. "Re-new!"

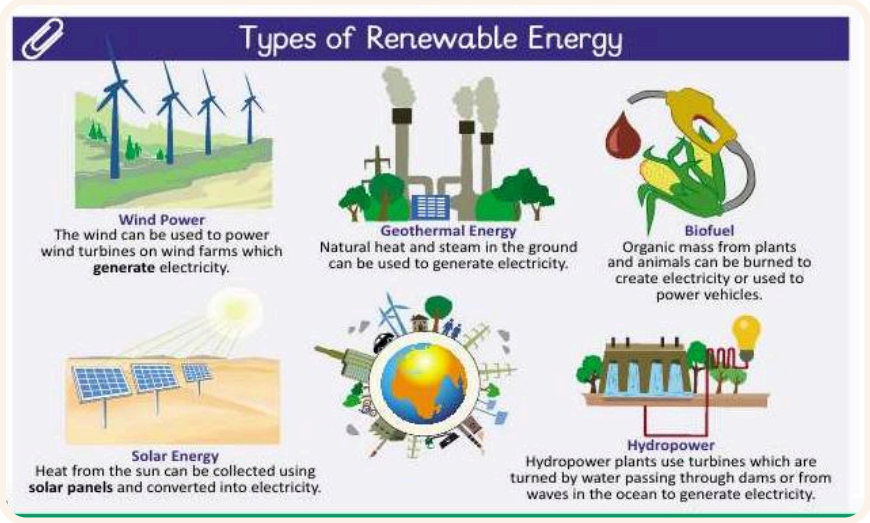
> 💡 Renewable = never runs out. Non-renewable = will run out.

" " *

Types of renewable energy

Uncle Bill's email continued:

> Here are the main types of renewable energy:
>
> **Wind power**: wind **turbines** on wind farms **generate** electricity.
>
> **Geothermal**: natural heat and steam in the ground.
>
> **Biofuel**: organic mass from plants and animals.
>
> **Solar power**: heat from the sun collected by **solar panels**.
>
> **Hydropower**: water passes through dams and turns turbines.



Types of renewable energy

Luke looked up **generate**. It means produce. And **convert** means change one thing into another.

"Turbines are on wind farms and in hydropower plants," Luke said. "They turn and make electricity."

He made a mistake in his notes: "Biofuel is produced using water." Then he read the email again and fixed it: "Biofuel comes from organic mass."

The best choice

For your trolley, solar power is best. Solar panels convert sunlight into electricity.

But inside a mall there is no sun, only lamps. So you need a strong panel and a small battery.

Remember, renewable energy is better for the environment.

Love, Uncle Bill

" " *

Problems and solutions

Luke listed problems and **suggested solutions**:

Problem: little sunlight inside the mall. Solution: charge the battery in the car park under the sun.

Problem: the trolley could move too fast. Solution: add a simple brake.

At the school science fair, Luke showed his model. A small solar panel was on top, and the trolley moved slowly by itself. His teacher smiled. "Solar energy will not run out. And neither will your ideas, Luke!"

📖 Words from the story

renewable متجدد	**non-renewable** غير متجدد
run out ينفد	**solar power** الطاقة الشمسية
wind power طاقة الرياح	**hydropower** الطاقة الكهرومائية
geothermal حرارية جوفية	**biofuel** وقود حيوي
turbine توربين	**generate** يولّد
convert يحوّل	**invention** اختراع

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Renewable energy comes from sources that never run out: wind, sun, biomass, water, geothermal heat
- ✔ Non-renewable energy will run out: oil, coal, natural gas, nuclear power
- ✔ Renewable energy is better for the environment
- ✔ Wind turbines and hydropower turbines generate electricity
- ✔ Solar panels convert the sun's heat and light into electricity
- ✔ Biofuel comes from organic mass, geothermal energy from heat in the ground
- ✔ Read the subject line of an email to guess its purpose

🤔 Little questions

1. Name three renewable sources
   Answer: sun, wind and water
2. Is natural gas renewable?
   Answer: No, it will run out
3. What converts sunlight into electricity?
   Answer: solar panels
4. What does generate mean?
   Answer: produce
5. What is the purpose of Luke's email?
   Answer: to ask for help with his school project



Lesson 3-2 · Grammar and Vocabulary: Conjunctions and adjective suffixes

The Linking Words Club

School story Unit 3: Renewable Energy

👥 Brothers Abdullah and Mohammed, who write a newsletter for their school in Saham

Abdullah and Mohammed wrote the school newsletter. This month the topic was renewable energy. But their first draft was a disaster. Every sentence was short and lonely.

> "Solar energy is clean. It is free. Panels are expensive. People don't buy them."

Their teacher, Mr Ahmed, read it. "Your sentences need friends! Use **conjunctions**. They link words and sentences and make writing clear."

Adding information

"To **add** information, use **moreover**, **in addition** or **also**," said Mr Ahmed.

Mohammed rewrote:

> Renewable energy is good for the environment. **Moreover**, it will not run out.
>
> Solar energy is clean. **In addition**, it is free.

"Notice the comma," said Mr Ahmed. "Use a comma after Moreover, However, Therefore and In addition at the start of a sentence."

Then Abdullah wrote: "I also can speak French."

"Careful! **Also** comes **before** a normal action verb, but **after** be and modal verbs like can. So: I can **also** speak French."

"I **also** like writing," said Abdullah. "Correct?"

"Correct!"

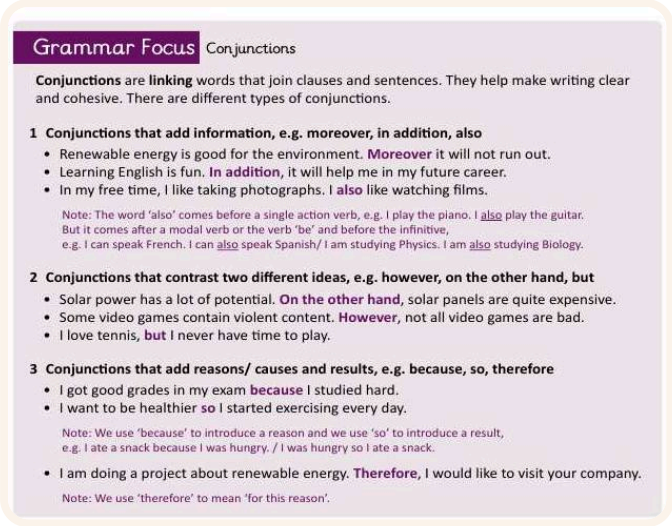
Contrasting ideas

"Now show a **contrast**, two different ideas," said Mr Ahmed. "Use **however**, **on the other hand** or **but**."

Mohammed wrote:

> Solar power has a lot of potential. **On the other hand**, panels are expensive.
>
> Solar panels are expensive. **However**, they save money over time.

I love solar energy, **but** my house doesn't have panels yet.



Grammar Focus Conjunctions

Conjunctions are **linking** words that join clauses and sentences. They help make writing clear and cohesive. There are different types of conjunctions.

1 Conjunctions that add information, e.g. moreover, in addition, also

- Renewable energy is good for the environment. **Moreover** it will not run out.
- Learning English is fun. **In addition,** it will help me in my future career.
- In my free time, I like taking photographs. I **also** like watching films.

Note: The word 'also' comes before a single action verb, e.g. I play the piano. I also play the guitar.
But it comes after a modal verb or the verb 'be' and before the infinitive,
e.g. I can speak French. I can also speak Spanish/ I am studying Physics. I am also studying Biology.

2 Conjunctions that contrast two different ideas, e.g. however, on the other hand, but

- Solar power has a lot of potential. **On the other hand,** solar panels are quite expensive.
- Some video games contain violent content. **However,** not all video games are bad.
- I love tennis, **but** I never have time to play.

3 Conjunctions that add reasons/ causes and results, e.g. because, so, therefore

- I got good grades in my exam **because** I studied hard.
- I want to be healthier **so** I started exercising every day.

Note: We use 'because' to introduce a reason and we use 'so' to introduce a result,
e.g. I ate a snack because I was hungry. / I was hungry so I ate a snack.

- I am doing a project about renewable energy. **Therefore,** I would like to visit your company.

Note: We use 'therefore' to mean 'for this reason'.

Grammar Focus: conjunctions

💡 Add: moreover, in addition, also. Contrast: however, on the other hand, but.

" " *

Reasons and results

"Last, **reasons and results**," said Mr Ahmed. "**Because** gives a reason. **So** gives a result. **Therefore** means for this reason."

Abdullah wrote:

People don't buy panels **because** they are expensive.

Panels are expensive, **so** people don't buy them.

We are doing a project. **Therefore**, we would like to visit a solar farm.

Then he wrote a sentence alone: "Because I studied hard."

"That is not a complete sentence," said Mr Ahmed. "Say: **I passed because I studied hard.**"

Making adjectives

For the newsletter title, the brothers wanted strong adjectives. Mr Ahmed explained **suffixes**: small endings added to a **root word**.

renew + **able** → renewable

beauty + **ful** → beautiful (y changes to i)

fame + **ous** → famous (drop the e)

create + **ive** → creative (drop the e)

option + **al** → optional

danger + **ous** → dangerous

"Don't write "beautyful"," laughed Mr Ahmed. "Y changes to i!"

Mohammed added one more: "Sustain + able → **sustainable**. Energy that can continue for a long time without harming the planet."

" " *

The final newsletter

The new headline said: **A Beautiful, Sustainable Future**. The article began:

Renewable energy is clean. Moreover, it will never run out. However, solar panels are still expensive. Therefore, our school is starting a small solar project, because we want to be creative and famous for green ideas!

Mr Ahmed read it and smiled. "Now your sentences are a happy family."

📖 Words from the story

conjunction
أداة ربط

moreover
علاوة على ذلك

in addition
بالإضافة إلى ذلك

however
ومع ذلك

on the other hand
من ناحية أخرى

therefore
لذلك

suffix
لاحقة

root word
الكلمة الأصل

sustainable
مستدام

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Conjunctions link words and sentences and make writing clear
- ✔ Add information: moreover, in addition, also
- ✔ Also comes before an action verb but after be and modal verbs: I can also speak French
- ✔ Contrast: however, on the other hand, but
- ✔ Reason: because. Result: so, therefore
- ✔ Use a comma after Moreover, However, Therefore, In addition at the start of a sentence
- ✔ Adjective suffixes: -able, -ful, -ous, -ive, -al (beauty → beautiful, fame → famous, create → creative)

🤔 Little questions

1. Which conjunction shows contrast?
   Answer: however
2. What is the adjective from create?
   Answer: creative
3. What is the adjective from fame?
   Answer: famous
4. Correct this: I also can speak Spanish.
   Answer: I can also speak Spanish.
5. Make an adjective: danger + ous
   Answer: dangerous



Lesson 3-3 · Listening and Speaking: Mir'aah solar project

A Field of Mirrors

School trip story Unit 3: Renewable Energy

👥 Grade 10 boys from a school in Adam on a trip, their teacher Mr Rashid, and engineer Hilal

The bus drove deep into the desert. Then the boys saw something amazing. Thousands of **mirrors** were shining in the sun like a silver sea.

"Welcome to the **Mir'aah Solar Project**," said Mr Rashid.

Predicting from the slides

Inside a cool room, engineer Hilal prepared a **presentation**. Before he started, Mr Rashid said, "Look at the slides and predict the content. Use **numbers and names** as key words while you listen."

The first slide showed a big oil field and mirrors. The boys guessed: "oil", "sun", "steam".

The presentation

Engineer Hilal began. "Mir'aah is one of the **largest solar energy plants in the world**. It is here, in an **oilfield** in Oman."

"Does it use solar panels?" asked a boy.

"No, and that is a common mistake. Mir'aah uses **large mirrors**. The mirrors focus the sunlight and make **steam**. This is a **solar steam generator**."

"And what is the steam for?"

"We use the steam to **extract** oil, to take it out of the ground. Before, we burned gas to make steam. Now the sun does it."

"How does this help the planet?"

"It reduces the oilfield's carbon footprint by about **300,000 tonnes** a year."

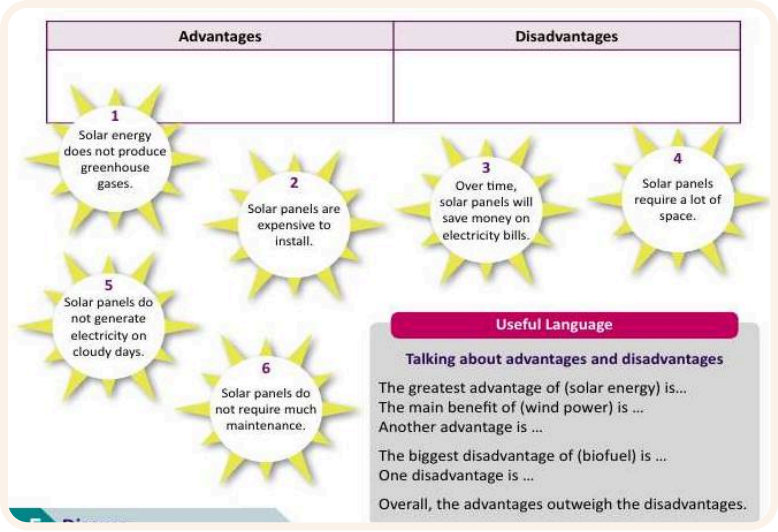
The boys completed their notes with the numbers.

💡 Mir'aah: large mirrors → steam → extract oil, cutting about 300,000 tonnes of carbon a year.

" " *

Advantages and disadvantages

Back at school, Mr Rashid drew two columns: **Advantages** and **Disadvantages**. "Sort these statements about solar energy."



Advantages and disadvantages of solar energy

It does not produce greenhouse gases. → Advantage

It saves money on electricity bills over time. → Advantage

It does not require much **maintenance**. → Advantage

Panels are expensive to install. → Disadvantage

Panels require a lot of space. → Disadvantage

Panels do not generate electricity on cloudy days. → Disadvantage

"Maintenance means fixing and looking after a machine," said Mr Rashid.

Useful language

"Now talk about advantages and disadvantages. Use these phrases," he said:

The greatest advantage of ... is ... / The main benefit of ... is ... / Another advantage is ...

The biggest disadvantage of ... is ... / One disadvantage is ...

Overall, the advantages **outweigh** the disadvantages.

"Outweigh means are greater than," said Mr Rashid.

A boy said, "The advantage of solar is expensive."

"Hmm, that doesn't make sense," said Mr Rashid. "Say: **One disadvantage of solar is that it is expensive.**"

" " *

Ideas for Oman

"Imagine wind turbines at our school," said Mr Rashid. "Give your opinion."

Yahya stood up. "**The greatest advantage** is free electricity. **One disadvantage** is the noise. **Overall, the advantages outweigh the disadvantages**."

Another boy said, "Oman has a lot of sun. Solar is **cost-effective** here. It gives good results for the money."

That night, Yahya told his father about the field of mirrors. "Dad, in Oman, even the sun works in the oil industry!"

📖 Words from the story

presentation عرض تقديمي	**advantage** ميزة
disadvantage عيب	**extract** يستخرج
oilfield حقل نفط	**steam** بخار
mirror مرآة	**maintenance** صيانة
cost-effective فعال من حيث التكلفة	**outweigh** يفوق

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Mir'aah is one of the largest solar energy plants in the world, in an oilfield in Oman
- ✔ It uses large mirrors, not solar panels, to focus sunlight and make steam
- ✔ The steam is used to extract oil
- ✔ It reduces the carbon footprint by about 300,000 tonnes a year
- ✔ Advantages of solar: no greenhouse gases, saves money over time, little maintenance
- ✔ Disadvantages: expensive to install, needs a lot of space, no electricity on cloudy days
- ✔ Phrases: The greatest advantage of ... is ... / One disadvantage is ... / Overall, the advantages outweigh the disadvantages

🤔 Little questions

1. Where is Mir'aah?
   Answer: in an oilfield in Oman
2. What does Mir'aah use to generate steam?
   Answer: large mirrors
3. What is the steam used for?
   Answer: to extract oil
4. Give one disadvantage of solar panels
   Answer: expensive to install
5. What does outweigh mean?
   Answer: to be greater than



Lesson 3-4 · Writing: A request email

Mazin's Polite Email

College story · Unit 3: Renewable Energy

👥 Mazin, a third-year Engineering student, and his older brother Saud

Mazin was a third-year **Engineering** student at the Science and Technology College. His team had an **assignment**: a report about a **sustainable project** in Oman. They chose the Mir'aah solar plant.

"We need to visit the **site**," said Mazin. "I'll write an email."

He typed quickly and showed his brother Saud:

> "Hi Mr Brown, I want to visit your company. Thanks!"

Saud laughed. "That's how you write to your friends! Mr Brown is a manager. You need a **formal** email."

Formal or informal?

"What's the difference?" asked Mazin.

Saud wrote two lists:

> **Formal**: Dear Mr Brown / Kind regards / I would like to ...
>
> **Informal**: Hi Bill / Thanks / Take care

"In a formal email, don't use short forms. Write **I am**, not I'm. And no slang. Use **would like** and **whether** to sound **polite**."

"So not "I want to visit"?"

"No. Say **I would like to visit** your company."

The structure

Saud drew the parts of a **request** email:

> Polite greeting: Dear Mr Brown,
>
> Polite opening sentence: I hope that you are very well.
>
> Introduce yourself: My name is ...
>
> The request: I am writing to request a visit to ...

Closing comment: Any help you can provide will be greatly **appreciated**.

Polite closing: Kind regards,

💡 Request email: greeting, opening, introduce yourself, the request with details, closing comment, polite closing.

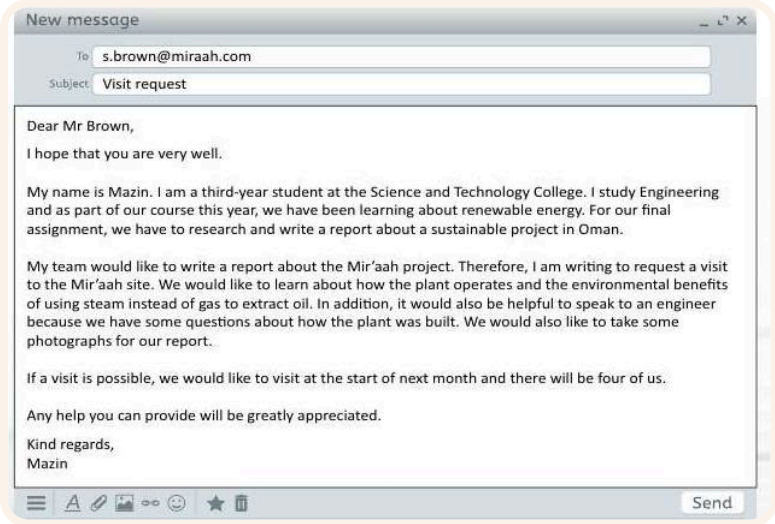
" " *

Mazin tries again

Mazin wrote: "I am writing for request a visit."

"Almost," said Saud. "It's **I am writing to request**."

Mazin fixed it and continued. He put the request clearly in the second and third paragraphs. Here is his final email:



Mazin's request email

To: Mr Brown, Mir'aah

Subject: Visit request

Dear Mr Brown,

I hope that you are very well.

My name is Mazin. I am a third-year Engineering student at the Science and Technology College. My team would like to write a report about a sustainable project in Oman.

I am writing to ask **whether** it would be possible to visit the Mir'aah site at the start of next month. We would like to learn how the plant works and about its

environmental benefits. We would also like to take some photos.

Any help you can provide will be greatly appreciated.

Kind regards,

Mazin

A puzzle

Saud gave Mazin a puzzle: "help me / if / to ask / I am writing / with / you / would / my project / be able to."

Mazin thought and wrote: **I am writing to ask if you would be able to help me with my project.**

"Perfect. Very polite!"

" " *

Three days later, Mazin got a reply. "Dear Mazin, Thank you for your email. We would be happy to welcome your team at the start of next month. Kind regards, Mr Brown."

Mazin jumped up. "It worked!"

"Of course," said Saud. "Polite words open doors."

📖 Words from the story

request طلب	**formal** رسمي
informal غير رسمي	**polite** مهذب
assignment مهمة / واجب	**site** موقع
appreciated مُقدَّر	**Kind regards** مع أطيب التحيات

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Mazin's email is a formal request to visit the Mir'aah site for a college report
- ✔ Formal: Dear Mr Brown, Kind regards, I would like to … Informal: Hi, Thanks, Take care
- ✔ Formal emails have no short forms and no slang
- ✔ Structure: polite greeting, opening sentence, introduce yourself, request, closing comment, polite closing
- ✔ Use would like and whether to sound polite
- ✔ Say I am writing to request, not I am writing for request
- ✔ State the request clearly in the second or third paragraph

🤔 Little questions

1. What is the purpose of Mazin's email?
   Answer: to make a request
2. Give a polite greeting
   Answer: Dear Mr Brown
3. Make it polite: I want to visit your company.
   Answer: I would like to visit your company.
4. Which part is Kind regards?
   Answer: a polite closing
5. When does Mazin's team want to visit?
   Answer: at the start of next month



Lesson 3-5 · Project: An invention powered by renewable energy

The Solar Case

Presentation story | Unit 3: Renewable Energy

👥 Ali and his team in a boys' school in Seeb: Hamza, Salim and Ali

Ali's phone died again. He was at the beach with his family and wanted to take a photo of the sunset. "**Running out of battery** is the worst!" he said.

His friend Hamza had an idea. "Let's make an **invention** for our English project. Something that charges your phone with the sun."

Planning with seven questions

The teacher, Mr Nabil, gave them seven questions to plan:

What is it? A phone case with a **solar panel**.

What problem does it solve? Running out of battery when you are out.

What energy does it use? Solar energy.

How does it work? (They drew a diagram.)

Advantages? Disadvantages? Name?

They called it **The Solar Case**.

How it works

Salim drew the steps:

solar panel → **battery** stores electricity → small **cable** connects to the phone

"The solar panel turns sunlight into electricity," Salim explained. "The battery stores it. And the cable passes it to the phone to **charge** it."

"Advantages?" asked Mr Nabil.

"It is eco-friendly. It is a **protective cover**, so it protects your phone. You can charge anywhere. And there is no need for a charger," said Hamza.



The Solar Case and tips for presentations

💡 Solar Case: solar panel → battery → cable → phone.

" " *

Presentation phrases

"Now prepare a **presentation**," said Mr Nabil. "Every group member must speak. Use these phrases."

Good morning, everyone. Welcome to our presentation about ...

This is the problem that inspired our design.

Our invention has two purposes. Firstly, ... Secondly, ...

The main advantage of our invention is ...

Thank you for listening. Does anyone have any questions?

Tips for presenting

Salim was nervous. "I will read every word from the slides."

"No," said Mr Nabil. "That's a common mistake. Here are some tips."

Practise before the presentation.

Use short notes, but do not read from slides.

Speak clearly and pause regularly.

Keep it simple.

Have open **body language**, relax and smile.

Make **eye contact** with the audience.

"Eye contact means looking at people's eyes," said Mr Nabil. "And body language is what your hands and face say."

" " *

Presentation day

Ali started. "Good morning, everyone. Welcome to our presentation about The Solar Case."

Hamza showed a photo of a dead phone at the beach. "This is the problem that inspired our design."

Salim took a deep breath, smiled and looked at the audience. "Our invention has two purposes. Firstly, it charges your phone with the sun. Secondly, it protects your phone."

Ali finished. "The main advantage of our invention is that you can charge anywhere. Thank you for listening. Does anyone have any questions?"

A boy asked, "Where is the electricity stored?"

"In the battery," said Salim confidently.

At the end, Salim said, "Thank you for listen!" Then he laughed and corrected himself. "Thank you for **listening**!" Everyone clapped.

📖 Words from the story

invention اختراع	**solar panel** لوح شمسي
battery بطارية	**cable** سلك
charge يشحن	**protective cover** غطاء واقٍ
eye contact تواصل بصري	**body language** لغة الجسد

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The Solar Case solves the problem of running out of phone battery
- ✔ How it works: solar panel → battery stores electricity → cable connects to the phone
- ✔ Advantages: eco-friendly, protects your phone, charge anywhere, no charger needed
- ✔ Plan an invention with seven questions: what, problem, energy, how, advantages, disadvantages, name
- ✔ Presentation phrases: Good morning, everyone. Welcome to … / Thank you for listening
- ✔ Tips: practise, use notes not slides, speak clearly, keep it simple, smile, make eye contact
- ✔ Every group member should speak

🤔 Little questions

1. What problem does the Solar Case solve?
   Answer: running out of phone battery
2. Where is electricity stored?
   Answer: in the battery
3. Give one body-language tip
   Answer: smile and make eye contact
4. Correct this: Thank you for listen.
   Answer: Thank you for listening.
5. Should you read every word from the slides?
   Answer: No, use short notes



Lesson 4-1 · Reading: Voices from the past

The Museum Night

Fantasy story Unit 4: Civilisation

👥 Hassan (15) on a school visit to the National Museum in Muscat, and four teenagers from the past

Hassan was bored at the National Museum. He sat on a bench in front of an old copper ingot. He closed his eyes for just a moment...

When he opened them, the hall was dark. Four teenagers stood in front of him, in strange clothes.

"Who are you?" Hassan whispered.

"We are **voices from the past**," said the first boy. "Each of us comes from a great **ancient civilisation**. Can you guess where?"

The first voice: Rome, 100 AD

The first boy wore a white cloth. "I am a **citizen** of a huge **empire**. We **conquered** many lands. Our citizens were 12% of the world population! Yesterday I went to the Colosseum. It can seat 50,000 people."

"You are **Roman**!" said Hassan. "An empire is a group of countries ruled by one ruler."

"Correct!"

The second voice: Majan, 950 BC

The second boy smiled. "My name is Mubarak. My father **trades** copper. He has a fleet of dhows, and we sail using the stars."

Hassan's eyes opened wide. "Copper and ships... you are from **Majan**! The ancient kingdom in Oman!"

"Yes. We were famous for **copper** and building ships. Some people think Majan was in Egypt, but no, it was here, in Oman."

Hassan felt proud. He looked at the copper ingot in the glass case. "Maybe your father made this."

" " *

The third voice: Sumer, 2100 BC

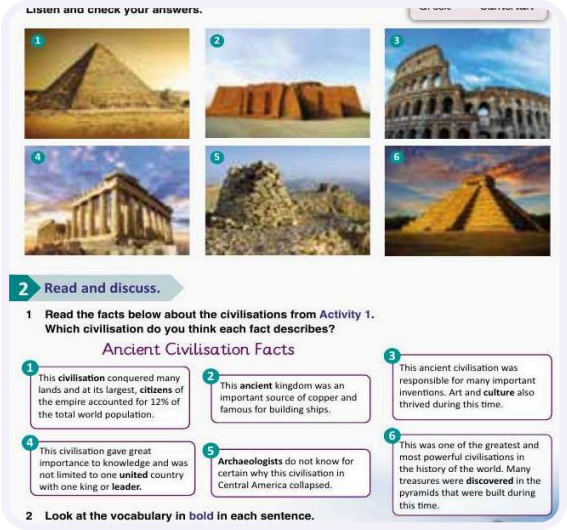
The third boy held a clay tablet. "My name is Iskur. I am training to be an accountant. I write in **cuneiform** on clay tablets. Near my house is the Great **Ziggurat** at Ur."

"You are **Sumerian**," said Hassan. "The Sumerians invented cuneiform, not the Romans."

The fourth voice: Egypt, 1500 BC

The last boy carried wheat. "In my land, **agriculture**, farming, is the main industry. People read **hieroglyphics**, picture writing. And our kings built huge **monuments**."

"The **pyramids**! You are **Egyptian**. Egypt was one of the most powerful civilisations."


Listen and check your answers.

2 Read and discuss.

1 Read the facts below about the civilisations from Activity 1. Which civilisation do you think each fact describes?

Ancient Civilisation Facts

1 This **civilisation** conquered many lands and at its largest, **citizens** of the empire accounted for 12% of the total world population.

2 This **ancient** kingdom was an important source of copper and famous for building ships.

3 This ancient civilisation was responsible for many important inventions. Art and **culture** also thrived during this time.

4 This civilisation gave great importance to knowledge and was not limited to one **united** country with one king or **leader**.

5 **Archaeologists** do not know for certain why this civilisation in Central America collapsed.

6 This was one of the greatest and most powerful civilisations in the history of the world. Many treasures were **discovered** in the pyramids that were built during this time.

2 Look at the vocabulary in **bold** in each sentence.

Ancient civilisations: pictures and facts

> 💡 Writing: cuneiform (Sumer) and hieroglyphics (Egypt). Majan (Oman): copper and ships.

Two more

"There are others," said Mubarak. "The **Greeks** were responsible for many inventions, art and culture. And the **Mayan** civilisation in Central America collapsed, and **archaeologists**, people who study the past, still do not know why."

" " *

Why study the past?

"Why did you come to me?" asked Hassan.

"Because your **society**, a large group of people who live together in an organised way, must remember us," said Iskur. "Study us to understand how people lived and worked. Learn from our inventions and our mistakes."

"Be proud of your history," said Mubarak, "like Majan. And protect the historical sites. They are the voices of your **economy**, your art, your life."

Suddenly the lights came on. "Hassan! Wake up! The bus is leaving!" called his teacher.

Hassan stood up and looked at the copper ingot again. He took out his notebook and wrote new words with their definitions. At the top he wrote: "Majan: copper and ships. My country's first voice."

📖 Words from the story

civilisation حضارة	**ancient** قديم
empire إمبراطورية	**citizen** مواطن
archaeologist عالم آثار	**trade** يتاجر / تجارة
society مجتمع	**economy** اقتصاد
monument نصب تذكاري	**agriculture** زراعة
cuneiform الكتابة المسمارية	**hieroglyphics** الكتابة الهيروغليفية

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Roman: conquered many lands, the Colosseum could seat 50,000 people
- ✔ Majan (Oman): an ancient kingdom famous for copper and building ships
- ✔ Sumer: cuneiform on clay tablets and the Great Ziggurat at Ur
- ✔ Egypt: agriculture was the main industry, hieroglyphics and the pyramids
- ✔ Greek civilisation gave many inventions, art and culture, and the Mayan civilisation collapsed for unknown reasons
- ✔ We study ancient civilisations to understand how people lived, learn from them, be proud of our history and protect historical sites
- ✔ Look for dates and places to identify each civilisation

🤔 Little questions

1. What was Majan famous for?
   Answer: copper and building ships
2. Who invented cuneiform?
   Answer: the Sumerians

3. What does empire mean?

   Answer: a group of countries ruled by one ruler

4. What are the two forms of writing in the texts?

   Answer: cuneiform and hieroglyphics

5. Was Majan in Egypt?

   Answer: No, it was in Oman

The Mystery of Ubar

Detective story · Unit 4: Civilisation

👥 Young detective Sultan (15) from Thumrait, and his uncle, a tour guide in Dhofar

Sultan loved mysteries. One day his uncle, a tour guide in Dhofar, took him to the ruins of Ubar.

"This is a famous mystery," said his uncle. "Ubar was called the Lost City. For hundreds of years, nobody knew where it was."

"So who found it?" asked Sultan.

"Ah. Listen carefully: **The Lost City of Ubar was found by archaeologists.**"

Active and passive

Sultan wrote two sentences in his detective notebook:

Active: People **traded** frankincense in ancient times.

Passive: **Frankincense was traded** in ancient times.

"What's the difference?" he asked.

"In the **active** sentence, we say what the **subject** does: people traded. In the **passive** sentence, we focus on the **object**: frankincense. **Frankincense** is more important here, because Ubar was a centre of the frankincense trade."

💡 Past passive = was / were + past participle.

When the doer is unknown

They walked through the broken walls. Sultan saw old marks of fire. "**The city was attacked**," said his uncle.

"By whom?"

"We don't know. That's why we use the passive: when the doer is **unknown or unimportant**."

Sultan wrote in his notebook: "We use the passive when we don't know or don't care who did the action."

" " *

Was or were?

"Uncle, how do I make the past passive?"

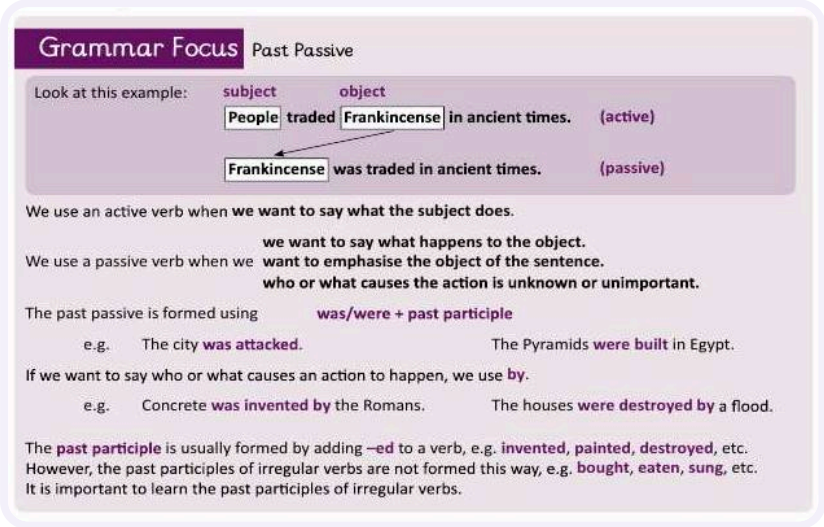
"**Was** or **were** + **past participle**. Singular object, use **was**. Plural object, use **were**."

> The city **was** attacked.
>
> The houses **were** destroyed **by** a flood.

"And if you want to say who did it, add **by**."

Sultan tested himself: "The Pyramids was built in Egypt."

"Wrong!" said his uncle. "Pyramids is plural. **The Pyramids were built** in Egypt."



Grammar Focus: the past passive

Past participles

"Some past participles are **regular**, they end in **-ed**: invented, painted, destroyed, used. Others are **irregular**: bought, eaten, sung, **built**, **found**, **written**."

Sultan wrote: "It was invent by the Romans." Then he crossed it out. "Invented! **Concrete was invented by the Romans.**"

"Good detective," laughed his uncle.

" " *

Sultan's detective report

At home, Sultan turned active sentences into passive ones for his class:

> The Sumerians invented cuneiform. → **Cuneiform was invented by the Sumerians.**

The Egyptians used the pyramids as **tombs** for the **pharaohs**. → **The pyramids were used as tombs for the pharaohs.**

A volcano destroyed the Roman city of Pompeii. → **Pompeii was destroyed.**

Archaeologists found Ubar. → **Ubar was found by archaeologists.**

He wrote one last line: "Mystery solved: The frankincense of Dhofar was loved by the whole ancient world."

📖 Words from the story

active مبني للمعلوم	**passive** مبني للمجهول
past participle التصريف الثالث للفعل	**subject** الفاعل
object المفعول به	**frankincense** اللبان
tomb قبر / مدفن	**pharaoh** فرعون

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Active focuses on the subject: People traded frankincense
- ✔ Passive focuses on the object: Frankincense was traded
- ✔ We use the passive when the doer is unknown or unimportant: The city was attacked
- ✔ Form: was / were + past participle
- ✔ Singular object → was, plural object → were: The Pyramids were built
- ✔ Add by to show the doer: Concrete was invented by the Romans
- ✔ Regular participles end in -ed, irregular ones include built, found, written, bought, eaten

🤔 Little questions

1. What is the form of the past passive?
   Answer: was/were + past participle
2. What is the past participle of build?
   Answer: built
3. Which word shows the doer?
   Answer: by
4. Make passive: The Sumerians invented cuneiform.
   Answer: Cuneiform was invented by the Sumerians.

5. Correct this: The Pyramids was built.

Answer: The Pyramids were built.



Lesson 4-3 · Listening and Speaking: Living together

The Wall of Wise Words

School story | Unit 4: Civilisation

👥 Girls in a school in Sohar: Amal, Rahma and Wafa, and their teacher Ms Zainab

Ms Zainab covered one wall of the classroom with big papers. On each paper was a famous **quote**.

"This is our Wall of Wise Words," she said. "Each quote tells us how people should live together."

The quotes

The girls read the first quote, from **Sultan Qaboos**: if we work in **unity and cooperation**, we will regenerate our glorious past.

"**Cooperation** means working together," said Amal.

The second quote said: "An eye for an eye only ends up making the whole world blind."

Rahma thought. "It's about **revenge**. If everyone hurts back, everyone suffers."

The third quote was from Martin Luther King: people should be judged by the content of their character.

"That's about **equality**," said Wafa. "Everyone is equal."

The last one said: "One child, one teacher, one book, one pen can change the world."

"**Education**!" they said together.

" " *

The United Nations

Then Ms Zainab played a recording about the **United Nations**. The girls listened for details.

The UN is an international organisation formed by governments to keep **peace** and friendly relations.

The UN **Charter** was signed on **26th June 1945**.

It has **6** official languages and 193 member states.

Its leader is the **Secretary General**.

The **Universal Declaration of Human Rights** was adopted on 10th December, now **Human Rights Day**.

"A charter is an official document of rules," explained Ms Zainab. "And a **declaration** is an official announcement."

Human rights in our own words

"Now explain some **human rights** articles in your own words," said Ms Zainab.

Article 1: all human beings are born free and equal.

Article 2: the same rights whatever race, colour, gender, language or religion.

Article 3: the right to life, freedom and security.

Article 26: everyone has the right to an education.

Amal explained Article 26: "Every person, boy or girl, has the right to go to school and learn."

Rahma explained Article 2: "Your **nationality**, your language or your colour doesn't change your rights."

> 💡 UN Charter: 26th June 1945. 6 official languages. Human Rights Day: 10th December.

" " *

Stronger opinions

Then the class had a small debate: "Inventions are more important than people in a civilisation."

Wafa said, "I think people are important."

"Make it stronger!" said Ms Zainab. "Use **adverbs of degree**."

"People are **very** important. I **absolutely** believe that people are more important than inventions."

"Good! Strong adverbs: **absolutely, definitely, certainly, really, extremely**. Weaker ones: **quite, fairly**, or I **suppose**."

Amal said, "I very love this topic."

"Careful," smiled Ms Zainab. "Say **I really love** this topic."

Rahma said, "Inventions are absolutely important."

"Hmm, we say **extremely** or **really** important. We use absolutely with strong words like amazing or love."

Rahma tried again. "I **definitely** think people are important, because people make inventions. For example, a teacher changes many lives."

At the end of the day, the girls added a new paper to the wall: "We can live together with cooperation, equality and education."



Debate opinions and adverbs of degree

📖 Words from the story

cooperation تعاون	**equality** مساواة
revenge انتقام	**charter** ميثاق
human rights حقوق الإنسان	**declaration** إعلان
nationality جنسية	**adverb of degree** ظرف الدرجة
absolutely تمامًا / بالتأكيد	**definitely** بالتأكيد

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Quotes teach unity and cooperation, no revenge, equality and education
- ✔ The UN keeps peace and friendly relations between countries
- ✔ The UN Charter was signed on 26th June 1945, with 6 official languages and 193 member states
- ✔ The UN is led by the Secretary General, and Human Rights Day is 10th December
- ✔ Article 1: born free and equal. Article 26: everyone has the right to an education
- ✔ Adverbs of degree make opinions stronger: very, really, absolutely, definitely, certainly
- ✔ Weaker: quite, fairly. Say I really love, not I very love

🤔 Little questions

1. How many official UN languages are there?
   Answer: 6
2. Who leads the UN?
   Answer: the Secretary General
3. When was the UN Charter signed?
   Answer: 26th June 1945
4. Give one adverb of degree
   Answer: absolutely
5. Correct this: I very love camping.
   Answer: I really love camping.



Lesson 4-4 · Writing: A biography

The Lion of the Sea

Biography story · Unit 4: Civilisation

👥 Grade 10 student Yaqoob from Sur, his grandfather, a retired dhow captain, and an English teacher

Yaqoob's English homework was to write a **biography**. "A biography is the story of a person's life, written by another person," said his teacher. "Write it in **time order** and in the **past simple**."

Yaqoob went to his grandfather, a retired dhow captain in Sur. "Grandpa, who is the greatest Omani **sailor**?"

Grandpa smiled. "Ahmed Bin Majid. The **Lion of the Sea**."

Born to the sea

"Ahmed Bin Majid **was born** around **1421** in Oman," Grandpa began, "to a family of professional sailors."

Yaqoob wrote it down. He almost wrote "He born in 1421", but he remembered. "We say **he was born**."

"**At a young age**, he took his first sailing trip with his father," Grandpa continued. "He also learned the **Qur'an**. **At the age of seventeen**, he became a sailor. And soon, he became a **Master Mariner**, a captain of the highest level."

A great navigator

"Why was he called the Lion of the Sea?"

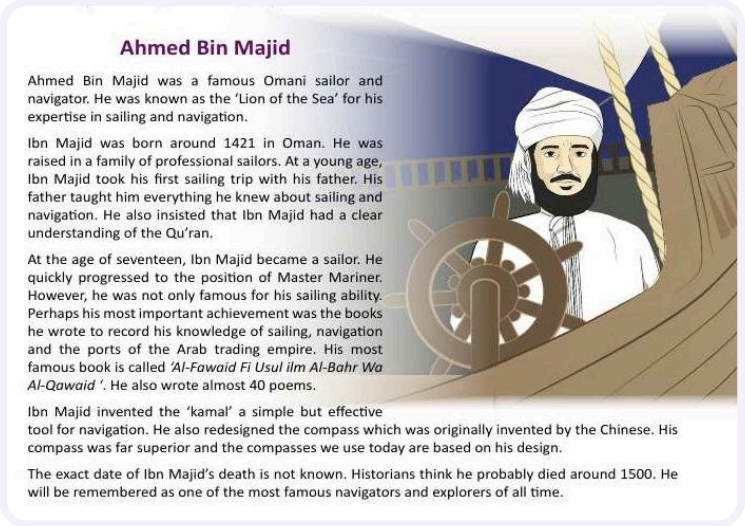
"Because of his **expertise**, his great skill and knowledge, in sailing and **navigation**. A **navigator** finds the way across the sea."

"What were his **achievements**?"

"He wrote books about sailing and navigation. **His most famous book was** "Al-Fawaid Fi Usul Ilm Al-Bahr Wa Al-Qawaid". He invented the **kamal**, a tool to measure the stars. And he redesigned the Chinese **compass**."

"When did he die?"

"Around **1500**. **He will be remembered as** one of the greatest navigators in history."



Ahmed Bin Majid

Ahmed Bin Majid was a famous Omani sailor and navigator. He was known as the 'Lion of the Sea' for his expertise in sailing and navigation.

Ibn Majid was born around 1421 in Oman. He was raised in a family of professional sailors. At a young age, Ibn Majid took his first sailing trip with his father. His father taught him everything he knew about sailing and navigation. He also insisted that Ibn Majid had a clear understanding of the Qu'ran.

At the age of seventeen, Ibn Majid became a sailor. He quickly progressed to the position of Master Mariner. However, he was not only famous for his sailing ability. Perhaps his most important achievement was the books he wrote to record his knowledge of sailing, navigation and the ports of the Arab trading empire. His most famous book is called *'Al-Fawaid Fi Usul ilm Al-Bahr Wa Al-Qawaid '*. He also wrote almost 40 poems.

Ibn Majid invented the 'kamal' a simple but effective tool for navigation. He also redesigned the compass which was originally invented by the Chinese. His compass was far superior and the compasses we use today are based on his design.

The exact date of Ibn Majid's death is not known. Historians think he probably died around 1500. He will be remembered as one of the most famous navigators and explorers of all time.

Biography: Ahmed Bin Majid

> 💡 A biography: past simple, time order, start with who the person is, end with how they will be remembered.

" " *

A modern Omani scientist

The next day the teacher said, "Now write sentences for a second biography. This time, a modern Omani: **Dr Lamya Al Haj**."

He gave the facts:

Born on 31st May 1982 in **Buraimi**, Oman.

BSc from **Sultan Qaboos University** in 2004 with high distinction.

MSc in Australia in 2006.

PhD in **Molecular Biology** in London in 2014.

L'Oreal UNESCO **Award** for Women in Science in 2018.

Yaqoob used the useful language:

Dr Lamya Al Haj **is a well-known** Omani scientist.

She was born on 31st May 1982 in Buraimi.

In 2004, she **graduated** from Sultan Qaboos University with a BSc in Science.

Two years later, she finished her MSc in Australia.

Her most important achievement was the L'Oreal UNESCO Award for Women

in Science in 2018.

In the future, she hopes to help more young Omanis study science.

He almost wrote "In 2004 she graduate". Then he fixed it: **graduated**, past simple!

" " *

Yaqoob showed his work to Grandpa. "Two Omanis, Grandpa. One explored the sea, one explores science."

Grandpa smiled. "And one day maybe someone will write your biography. Maybe an **entrepreneur**, a business person, or an **ambassador** for Oman!"

"Then I must do something worth writing," said Yaqoob.

📖 Words from the story

biography سيرة ذاتية (يكتبها شخص آخر)	**navigator** ملاح
sailor بحار	**expertise** خبرة
compass بوصلة	**achievement** إنجاز
graduate يتخرج	**award** جائزة
entrepreneur رائد أعمال	**ambassador** سفير

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ A biography tells a person's life in time order, in the past simple
- ✔ Ahmed Bin Majid was born around 1421 in Oman to a family of sailors
- ✔ At seventeen he became a sailor and soon a Master Mariner
- ✔ He wrote books on navigation, invented the kamal and redesigned the Chinese compass
- ✔ He was called the Lion of the Sea because of his expertise
- ✔ Dr Lamya Al Haj was born in Buraimi, studied at SQU, Australia and London, and won a UNESCO award in 2018
- ✔ Phrases: At a young age … / In (year) … / His most important achievement was … / He will be remembered as …

🤔 Little questions

1. When was Ibn Majid born?
   Answer: around 1421
2. What did he invent?
   Answer: the kamal
3. Why was he called the Lion of the Sea?
   Answer: because of his expertise in sailing and navigation
4. Where was Dr Lamya born?
   Answer: Buraimi
5. Correct this: He born in 1421.
   Answer: He was born in 1421.



Lesson 4-5 · Project: A leaflet about an archaeological site

The Port of Frankincense

Team project story · Unit 4: Civilisation

👥 A boys' group in Salalah: Musallam, Ahmed, Kamal and Nasser

"Name some **archaeological sites** in Oman," said Mr Saeed.

Hands went up. "Bahla Fort!" "Bat tombs!" "Ubar!" "Al Baleed!"

"Excellent. Your project is to make an **information leaflet** about one site. A leaflet is a small printed paper that gives information."

Musallam's group chose **Al Baleed**, because it was in their city, Salalah.

How to research

"First, how will you **research** it?" asked Mr Saeed.

The group listed ways:

Looking for information online or in a book.

Asking a history teacher.

Contacting the Ministry of Heritage and Culture.

Visiting the site or the national museum.

Kamal found a website that said Al Baleed was in Muscat. "Look!"

"Be careful," said Mr Saeed. "Some information online is not correct. Use **reliable** sources, sources you can trust. Which is more reliable: a random website or the Ministry of Heritage and Culture?"

"The Ministry, because it is an official source," said Ahmed.

"And always check facts in two sources."

💡 Use reliable sources and check facts in two sources.

" " *

Visiting the site

On Friday, the boys visited Al Baleed Archaeological Park with Musallam's father. They read the information boards and took notes.

Al Baleed was the most important ancient **port** on the Arabian Sea, in Salalah, Dhofar.

The site dates back to **2000 BC**.

It became a centre of the **frankincense trade**.

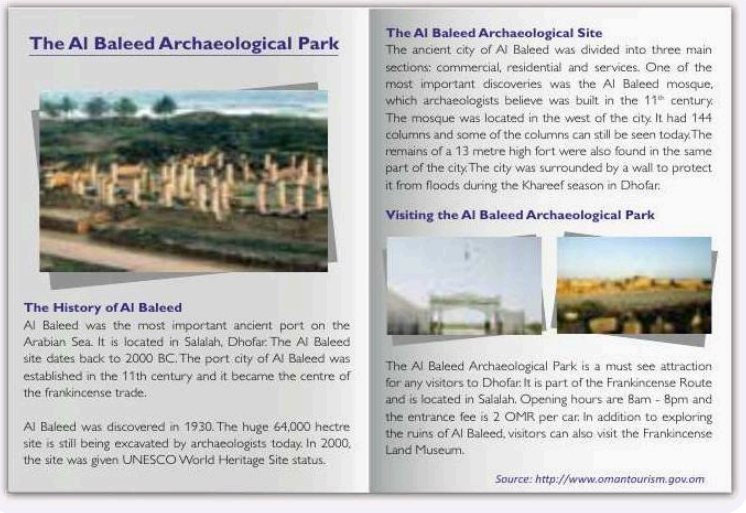
It was discovered in **1930**. It is a huge 64,000-hectare site, still being **excavated**.

In **2000**, it became a UNESCO **World Heritage Site**.

Al Baleed mosque had **144 columns** and was built in the 11th century.

"Excavated means archaeologists are still digging to find things," said Musallam's father.

Nasser stood among the **ruins**, the old broken buildings. "Ships from India and China came here to buy our frankincense," he said. "Amazing."



The Al Baleed Archaeological Park

The History of Al Baleed

Al Baleed was the most important ancient port on the Arabian Sea. It is located in Salalah, Dhofar. The Al Baleed site dates back to 2000 BC. The port city of Al Baleed was established in the 11th century and it became the centre of the frankincense trade.

Al Baleed was discovered in 1930. The huge 64,000 hectre site is still being excavated by archaeologists today. In 2000, the site was given UNESCO World Heritage Site status.

The Al Baleed Archaeological Site

The ancient city of Al Baleed was divided into three main sections: commercial, residential and services. One of the most important discoveries was the Al Baleed mosque, which archaeologists believe was built in the 11th century. The mosque was located in the west of the city. It had 144 columns and some of the columns can still be seen today. The remains of a 13 metre high fort were also found in the same part of the city. The city was surrounded by a wall to protect it from floods during the Khareef season in Dhofar.

Visiting the Al Baleed Archaeological Park

The Al Baleed Archaeological Park is a must see attraction for any visitors to Dhofar. It is part of the Frankincense Route and is located in Salalah. Opening hours are 8am - 8pm and the entrance fee is 2 OMR per car. In addition to exploring the ruins of Al Baleed, visitors can also visit the Frankincense Land Museum.

Source: http://www.omantourism.gov.om

Leaflet: Al Baleed Archaeological Park

Planning the leaflet

Back at school, they answered the planning questions:

Which site? Al Baleed Archaeological Park.

How did we research it? A book, the Ministry website and a visit.

What information? History, the site, visiting times and prices.

Design? A4 size, folded in three. Colours: sea blue and sand yellow. Images: the port, the mosque columns, frankincense.

" " *

The leaflet

Kamal wrote the title: **Al Baleed: The Port of Frankincense**. Ahmed wrote short sections with headings: "History", "What to See", "Visitor Information". Musallam added pictures. Nasser wrote about the **attraction** for tourists: the museum of frankincense next to the park.

"A good leaflet has a clear title, short sections with headings, pictures and visitor information," said Mr Saeed. "You have all of them."

For practice, he asked the class to write a heading for a leaflet about Bahla Fort. Kamal wrote: "Bahla Fort: A Treasure of Omani History."

The leaflets were printed and given to tourists at the Salalah airport during the Khareef season. Musallam smiled when he saw a family reading one. "Our history is travelling again," he said, "just like the frankincense ships."

📖 Words from the story

archaeological site موقع أثري	**leaflet** نشرة / مطوية
research بحث	**reliable** موثوق
excavate يُنقّب	**ruins** أطلال / آثار
World Heritage Site موقع تراث عالمي	**port** ميناء
attraction معلم جذب	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Ways to research: online or books, a history teacher, the Ministry of Heritage and Culture, visiting the site or museum
- ✔ Use reliable sources and check facts in two sources
- ✔ Al Baleed was the most important ancient port on the Arabian Sea, in Salalah, Dhofar
- ✔ It dates back to 2000 BC and was a centre of the frankincense trade
- ✔ It was discovered in 1930 and became a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2000
- ✔ Al Baleed mosque had 144 columns
- ✔ A good leaflet has a clear title, short sections with headings, pictures and visitor information

🤔 Little questions

1. Where is Al Baleed?
   Answer: Salalah, Dhofar
2. What trade made it famous?
   Answer: frankincense
3. When did it become a World Heritage Site?
   Answer: in 2000
4. How many columns did the mosque have?
   Answer: 144
5. Which source is more reliable: a random website or the Ministry?
   Answer: the Ministry, because it is official